

ENGLISH FOR DELIVERY AND DISPATCH

Truck and Delivery Driver English

Clear details. Reliable handovers.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.



Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For truck drivers, delivery drivers, dispatchers, receiving staff, and route coordinators.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight delivery lessons, plus extended conversations about time zones, detention charges, and route-height checks.

01 Confirming the delivery destination

4

The right address, the wrong entrance | Resolve conflicting location information through specific questions, a complete read-back, and a request to correct the record.

02 Checking shipment counts

13

Twelve on paper, eleven at receiving | Compare document and physical quantities, distinguish cartons from contents, and report an unresolved shortage without assigning blame.

03 Updating an arrival estimate

22

An estimate after the cutoff | Compare an estimated arrival with a receiving deadline and commit to a specific update without promising acceptance.

04 Describing a delivery exception

31

A crushed corner is not a finding of fault | Record visible packaging condition, attribute a customer concern, and resist unsupported conclusions about contents or responsibility.

05 When the recipient cannot receive

40

The contact answers, but the office is closed | Distinguish contact from availability, explain an unconfirmed wait, and refer delivery alternatives without inventing arrangements.

06 Explaining the booked service boundary

49

Curbside is not upstairs placement | Explain the booked service, acknowledge a different need, and route a change request without promising price or timing.

07 Matching a return to its collection

58

Two booked cartons and one extra | Match goods to a return reference, isolate an unmatched item, and request clarification without silently expanding the collection.

08 Closing a route with a clear handoff

67

One missing upload, one refusal | Hand over distinct delivery outcomes and unfinished records, attributing a reported reason and assigning each follow-up explicitly.

Communication field notes

3

Three more workplace conversations

76

Answers and explanations

85

Fast-access phrase pages

104

Vocabulary index

106

Sources and publication notes

114

Keep the delivery story accurate.

A clear delivery conversation connects the shipment reference to a checked fact and a specific next action. It distinguishes an estimate from an appointment, an observation from a cause, and a received shipment from a successfully uploaded record.

Confirm the receiving point

A correct street address may still lead to the wrong suite or entrance. Repeat the consignee, unit number, and receiving point, and refer conflicting instructions for correction.

"Suite 4 uses the staffed front desk; the rear annex belongs to suite 6."

Give the basis of a discrepancy

State the documented count and the physical count together. Distinguish external packaging from uninspected contents, and do not turn a difference into an unsupported finding of loss or fault.

"The document lists twelve cartons; we count eleven. Contents have not been checked."

Separate estimates and commitments

An estimated arrival does not extend a receiving cutoff or confirm a later slot. Give a time for the next update without presenting it as a guaranteed delivery time.

"Arrival is estimated at 11:40; I will update you by 10:40 about the receiving arrangement."

Hand over ownership and status

Name each unfinished item separately and confirm who will act next. A person accepting a follow-up does not mean that a receipt has uploaded or a refused shipment has been resolved.

"Jo will check the missing receipt upload and contact customer service about the refusal."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All shipments, people, businesses, times, references, and service arrangements are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not driving, loading, vehicle operation, cargo securement, legal liability, or regulatory compliance. Calls occur while the driver is safely parked or away from driving duties. Follow applicable road and working-time rules, carrier procedures, site safety requirements, and emergency arrangements. Do not use these dialogues as authorization to move, unload, leave, sign for, or alter the service for a real shipment.

The right address, the wrong entrance

A Read the situation

Resolve conflicting location information through specific questions, a complete read-back, and a request to correct the record.

Driver Leo is safely parked and calls receiving contact Hana about shipment 418 for Alder Books, 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. Hana confirms that the rear annex belongs to suite 6 and that suite 4 receives through its staffed front desk. Leo must report the conflict to dispatch for correction. The shipment has not been handed over, and this call does not itself update the route record or authorize a different delivery destination.

PEOPLE / Leo: Delivery driver | Hana: Receiving contact

READ BACK THE DETAIL THAT CHANGES THE ACTION

A vague confirmation such as yes, this building can conceal a wrong suite or entrance. Ask about the specific receiving point, repeat the corrected details together, and explain who must amend the route note before treating the record as corrected.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who is the shipment for?

- A The rear-annex tenant only
- C Any business in the building

- B Alder Books in suite 4
- D Alder Books in suite 6

2. What is wrong with the route note?

- A The front desk is unstaffed
- C The street number is missing

- B The rear annex belongs to suite 6
- D The shipment has already arrived elsewhere

3. What remains to be done?

- A Mark the shipment handed over
- C Describe the record as already corrected

- B Change the consignee to suite 6
- D Dispatch must correct the conflicting note

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

consignee

Named party intended to receive a shipment.

IN USE confirm the consignee

shipper

Party sending the goods.

IN USE identify the shipper

carrier

Business transporting the shipment.

IN USE contact the carrier

shipment reference

Identifier used to locate a particular shipment.

IN USE quote the shipment reference

delivery address

Stated location to which goods are to be delivered.

IN USE verify the delivery address

suite number

Identifier for a separate unit within a building.

IN USE read back the suite number

receiving point

Specific place where the intended recipient receives goods.

IN USE confirm the receiving point

route note

Written information supplied for a delivery stop.

IN USE check the route note

rear annex

Additional part of a building located at the back.

IN USE distinguish the rear annex

staffed front desk

Front reception point with personnel present.

IN USE identify the staffed front desk

entrance

Access point into a building or site.

IN USE clarify the entrance

address line

Separate part of a written address.

IN USE preserve the address line

Precision check

The street address is not the dispute. Suite 4 and suite 6 use different receiving points. The shipment remains for Alder Books in suite 4; identifying the front desk does not transfer the shipment to another consignee.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

dispatch

Team coordinating vehicles, drivers, and delivery instructions.

IN USE notify dispatch

receiving contact

Person contacted about receiving a shipment.

IN USE call the receiving contact

location conflict

Inconsistency between two descriptions of a destination.

IN USE report a location conflict

read-back

Spoken repetition used to check exact information.

IN USE request a complete read-back

destination correction

Amendment to incorrect destination information.

IN USE request a destination correction

site instruction

Direction applying at a particular receiving location.

IN USE verify the site instruction

delivery record

Recorded information about a delivery and its status.

IN USE update the delivery record

handover

Transfer of goods to the appropriate receiving party.

IN USE confirm the handover

stop number

Identifier for one location in a planned route sequence.

IN USE state the stop number

vehicle profile

Vehicle-specific dimensions and restrictions entered for route planning.

IN USE verify the vehicle profile

clearance

Available space around or above a vehicle; height must match the specific route.

IN USE verify overhead clearance

record amendment

Authorized change to existing recorded information.

IN USE confirm the record amendment

Precision check

Confirmation by a receiving contact and amendment of the route record are separate steps. Leo can accurately report the corrected receiving information while stating that dispatch has not yet corrected the note or completed the delivery.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE SHIPMENT

"I am calling about shipment 418 for Alder Books."

CHECK THE UNIT

"The shipment lists suite 4; is that your unit?"

DISTINGUISH THE ANNEX

"The rear annex belongs to suite 6."

GIVE THE CONFIRMED LOCATION

"We use the staffed front desk."

CONFIRM THE STREET

"Is the address 26 Mill Street?"

NAME THE CONFLICT

"My route note says rear annex."

ASK FOR THE RECEIVING POINT

"Where does suite 4 receive deliveries?"

READ BACK THE FULL DETAIL

"Alder Books, suite 4, staffed front desk; correct?"

For versus at

For names the intended recipient; at gives the location.

Belongs to

Connects the annex specifically to suite 6.

Not yet

Preserves an unfinished record update without implying refusal.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE CONSIGNEE

"The recipient has not changed."

REFER THE CORRECTION

"I will ask dispatch to correct the note."

AVOID CLAIMING HANDOVER

"The shipment has not been handed over."

EXPLAIN THE PURPOSE

"I want to avoid treating the annex as your receiving point."

SEPARATE NEIGHBORS

"Suite 6 is a different unit."

KEEP STATUS ACCURATE

"The route record has not been amended yet."

CHECK THE SOURCE

"Are you the receiving contact for suite 4?"

CLOSE THE CLARIFICATION

"I have the corrected information to report to dispatch."

Staffed

Describes personnel being present, not a general delivery authorization.

This building

Too broad when several units use different receiving points.

Corrected information

Can be known before the official record has been amended.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back matches the facts?

- A** Alder Books, suite 6, rear annex.
- B** Any desk at 26 Mill Street.
- C** Suite 4, unattended rear annex.
- D** Alder Books, suite 4, staffed front desk.

2. Which statement wrongly reports completion?

- A** The shipment has not been handed over.
- B** Dispatch has already corrected the note.
- C** I will report the conflict to dispatch.
- D** The annex belongs to suite 6.

3. Which question targets the actual ambiguity?

- A** Does the rear annex serve suite 4 or suite 6?
- B** Does suite 4 still use number 26?
- C** Is 418 the stop number or the shipment number?
- D** Does Alder Books use a different trading name?

4. What should remain unchanged?

- A** The assumption that all suites share an entrance
- B** A false completed-handover status
- C** The intended consignee, Alder Books
- D** The incorrect rear-annex note

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The right address, the wrong entrance

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

consignee / record amendment / handover / receiving contact / adjacent unit / location conflict / rear annex / dispatch / receiving point / read-back

- 01 **Leo:** Hello, I'm parked nearby with shipment 418 for Alder Books. Could I check the entrance? The address and route note don't seem to agree.
- 02 **Hana:** Yes, I'm the ¹ _____ for Alder Books. Which address and entrance have you been given?
- 03 **Leo:** Twenty-six Mill Street, suite four. Under instructions it says rear annex. Does the annex serve your part of the building?
- 04 **Hana:** No, the ² _____ belongs to suite six. We're in suite four; you've got the correct street number.
- 05 **Leo:** That explains it. I was checking the building number again, but it's the entrance note that needs attention.
- 06 **Hana:** Our ³ _____ is the staffed front desk. The other tenant uses the annex, so the two shouldn't be mixed up.
- 07 **Leo:** Let me check I've got it: Alder Books, twenty-six Mill Street, suite four, staffed front desk. The rear annex is suite six.
- 08 **Hana:** Your ⁴ _____ is right. Please keep the suite number with the entrance so it doesn't get separated again.
- 09 **Leo:** I haven't handed the shipment over. I'll report the conflict to dispatch before treating the instructions as corrected.
- 10 **Hana:** The ⁵ _____ is still Alder Books. We're not asking you to deliver to a different business.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Leo:** Understood. I'd also like the note fixed for the next visit; otherwise another driver will have the same problem.
- 12 **Hana:** Please ask ⁶ _____ about that. I can confirm our entrance, but I can't change your route record from here.
- 13 **Leo:** I'll report that Hana at receiving confirmed the staffed front desk for suite four, while the note points to the annex.
- 14 **Hana:** That describes the ⁷ _____ clearly. There's no correction to the street number itself.
- 15 **Leo:** Just checking: suite six isn't another department of Alder Books? I don't want the note to imply either desk can receive for you.
- 16 **Hana:** It's an ⁸ _____, separate from us. Your shipment names suite four, and that's the detail to preserve.
- 17 **Leo:** Thanks. I'll keep the delivery open while I speak with dispatch. This call hasn't completed the stop.
- 18 **Hana:** Right, no ⁹ _____ has taken place. You've confirmed where our receiving point is.
- 19 **Leo:** So I have corrected information to pass on, but the old route note is still there until dispatch amends it.
- 20 **Hana:** Exactly. The ¹⁰ _____ is pending. Suite four, staffed front desk is the receiving information to report.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. receiving contact | 2. rear annex | 3. receiving point | 4. read-back | 5. consignee | 6. dispatch | 7. location conflict | 8. adjacent unit | 9. handover | 10. record amendment

Correct another entrance conflict

F Say it

Shipment 529 names Birch Print, suite 2 at 14 Oak Lane. A side-door note belongs to suite 3. The receiving contact confirms suite 2 uses the main reception. Dispatch correction is pending.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / Birch Print / reception / 3

Driver: "The consignee is ¹ _____."

Receiver: "Suite 2 uses the main ² _____."

Driver: "The side-door note belongs to suite ³ _____."

Receiver: "The record correction is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. Birch Print | 2. reception | 3. 3 | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the full destination: Alder Books, 26 Mill Street, suite 4, staffed front desk.
2. Contrast suite 4 with suite 6 and the rear annex in turns 4 and 8.
3. Read the final record status without claiming dispatch has amended it or goods were handed over.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Twelve on paper, eleven at receiving

A Read the situation

Compare document and physical quantities, distinguish cartons from contents, and report an unresolved shortage without assigning blame.

At Finch Office Supplies, driver Priya and receiver Ben compare a bill of lading listing twelve cartons with their physical count of eleven. They agree on eleven present cartons. The contents have not been checked, and dispatch has not located a twelfth carton. The difference is one carton against the listed quantity, not a verified count of missing individual products. They need a factual discrepancy report and a dispatch follow-up, not a guess about where the carton was lost.

PEOPLE / Priya: Driver | Ben: Receiver

COUNT TOGETHER, DESCRIBE THE DIFFERENCE NEUTRALLY

A receiving discrepancy can create pressure to assign blame immediately. State both figures and their sources, then identify what has not been checked. Agreement about a physical count does not establish the contents or the cause of a shortage.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the bill of lading list?

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A One carton | B Twelve pallets |
| C Twelve cartons | D Eleven individual products |

2. What do Priya and Ben physically count?

- | | |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A Twelve cartons | B Eleven verified products |
| C One opened carton | D Eleven cartons |

3. What remains unknown?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A The agreed physical carton count | B The difference between twelve and eleven |
| C Contents and the location of the twelfth carton | D The listed carton count |

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

bill of lading

Transport document recording shipment details and carriage terms, often BOL.

IN USE compare the bill of lading

carton

Individual outer box counted in this shipment.

IN USE count the cartons

piece count

Number of stated shipping units, with the unit defined.

IN USE verify the piece count

listed quantity

Amount recorded on the relevant document.

IN USE state the listed quantity

physical count

Count of units actually observed.

IN USE perform a physical count

shortage

Quantity below the expected or documented amount.

IN USE report a carton shortage

discrepancy

Difference between records or observations requiring clarification.

IN USE document a discrepancy

recount

A further count to check the original figure.

IN USE request a recount

shipping unit

Unit used for shipment counting, such as a carton or pallet.

IN USE identify the shipping unit

pallet

Platform used to support and move grouped goods.

IN USE distinguish pallets from cartons

packing list

Document describing items packed in a shipment.

IN USE consult the packing list

line item

Separate entry on a shipment or order document.

IN USE compare the line item

Precision check

Twelve listed cartons minus eleven counted cartons gives a one-carton discrepancy. That calculation says nothing about the number of individual products missing or the contents of the cartons present, because no contents check has occurred.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

contents

Goods inside the outer packaging.

IN USE distinguish cartons from contents

item quantity

Number of individual goods rather than outer packages.

IN USE check the item quantity

unchecked

Not yet examined or verified.

IN USE mark contents as unchecked

short by

Expression stating the amount below an expected quantity.

IN USE report short by one carton

overage

Quantity above the expected or documented amount.

IN USE report an overage

quantity basis

Unit and reference used for a numerical comparison.

IN USE state the quantity basis

receiving tally

Count recorded when goods arrive.

IN USE compare the receiving tally

trace request

Request to investigate the location or movement of a shipment.

IN USE raise a trace request

unlocated carton

Carton whose current location has not been established.

IN USE report the unlocated carton

dispatch follow-up

Further action by the delivery coordination team.

IN USE request dispatch follow-up

joint count

Count checked by two parties together.

IN USE confirm the joint count

cause attribution

Statement assigning a reason or responsibility for an event.

IN USE avoid unsupported cause attribution

Precision check

A carton, pallet, and individual item are different counting units. State the unit every time figures could be confused. A shared count improves clarity but does not prove where an unlocated carton went or who caused the discrepancy.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE DOCUMENT

"The bill of lading lists twelve cartons."

GIVE THE DIFFERENCE

"That is one carton short of the listed quantity."

CONFIRM AGREEMENT

"Do you also have eleven in your count?"

STATE THE LOCATION LIMIT

"Dispatch has not located the twelfth carton."

STATE THE OBSERVATION

"We have counted eleven cartons here."

KEEP UNITS EXPLICIT

"I mean cartons, not individual products."

SEPARATE CONTENTS

"We have not checked the contents."

AVOID BLAME

"We do not yet know the cause of the difference."

Short by one

Gives the size and direction of the difference.

Listed versus counted

Separates a document figure from a physical observation.

Cartons versus contents

Outer packages do not establish the number or condition of goods inside.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE BOTH FIGURES

"Please record twelve listed and eleven counted."

AVOID INVENTING A RESULT

"I cannot say it is at another depot."

KEEP THE SOURCE CLEAR

"Twelve comes from the document; eleven comes from our count."

SUMMARIZE THE ISSUE

"One carton is unaccounted for against the listed quantity."

ASK FOR FOLLOW-UP

"Can dispatch investigate the unlocated carton?"

CORRECT A BROAD CLAIM

"Eleven cartons does not mean eleven products."

DISTINGUISH A TRACE

"A trace request is not a confirmed location."

CLOSE WITH THE OPEN ITEM

"The carton discrepancy remains unresolved."

Unlocated versus lost

Lack of a known location is not a completed investigation of loss.

We both count

Establishes agreement without establishing the cause.

Against

Introduces the reference amount used for comparison.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which discrepancy report is accurate?

- A** Eleven cartons prove all contents are complete.
- B** Dispatch lost one carton at the depot.
- C** Twelve cartons listed, eleven counted, contents unchecked.
- D** Twelve products listed, eleven products received.

2. Which calculation matches the count?

- A** Twelve cartons missing.
- B** One carton below the listed quantity.
- C** One carton above the listed quantity.
- D** Eleven cartons missing.

3. Which statement exceeds the evidence?

- A** The contents have not been checked.
- B** The missing carton is definitely at another depot.
- C** Dispatch has not located the twelfth carton.
- D** Both people count eleven cartons.

4. What should a follow-up preserve?

- A** A product count inferred from the carton count.
- B** A second-delivery time not supplied here.
- C** Only the difference, without the listed and counted figures.
- D** The quantity basis and unresolved location.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Twelve on paper, eleven at receiving

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

listed quantity / contents / unlocated carton / cause attribution / dispatch follow-up / short by / quantity basis / physical count / joint count / discrepancy

- 01 **Ben:** My tally is eleven cartons, but this bill of lading says twelve. Can you check the count with me before we report it?
- 02 **Priya:** Yes. The ¹ _____ is twelve cartons. I also count eleven cartons here, so our physical counts agree.
- 03 **Ben:** Then we're one carton short against the document. I'll include both totals so the difference isn't mistaken for the received count.
- 04 **Priya:** Exactly. We are ² _____ one carton against the twelve listed. I will keep both numbers in the message rather than reporting the difference alone.
- 05 **Ben:** I was about to write one item missing. That's too vague, isn't it? I haven't opened the boxes or counted the products inside.
- 06 **Priya:** Keep the ³ _____ as cartons. One missing outer box does not tell us how many individual products it contains.
- 07 **Ben:** Right, it's the outer boxes we've counted. The paperwork shouldn't suggest we've checked every product or its condition.
- 08 **Priya:** We should state that the ⁴ _____ are unchecked. That leaves a clear distinction between what we counted and what still needs verification.
- 09 **Ben:** Has dispatch found the twelfth carton anywhere? Our team will ask whether to expect another delivery, and I don't have an answer.
- 10 **Priya:** Dispatch has no confirmed location for the ⁵ _____. I cannot say it is at another depot or promise a later delivery.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Ben:** Please leave that open in the report. Agreeing that there are eleven here doesn't make the twelve-carton order complete.
- 12 **Priya:** It will record the ⁶ _____ explicitly: twelve listed, eleven counted, contents unchecked, and the twelfth carton not located.
- 13 **Ben:** Could the twelve on the document be an error? I don't know that it is; I'm asking whether that needs checking too.
- 14 **Priya:** That needs checking too. Our ⁷ _____ establishes eleven here; it does not tell us whether the document or the shipment movement explains the difference.
- 15 **Ben:** That makes sense. I'll report the shortage without writing that someone lost it. We haven't established where the difference arose.
- 16 **Priya:** Thank you. Unsupported ⁸ _____ would go beyond what either of us observed. A precise count gives dispatch something concrete to investigate.
- 17 **Ben:** Can the follow-up use this shipment reference? I don't want it passed on as a query about one individual office-supply item.
- 18 **Priya:** The ⁹ _____ should use the shipment details and the one-carton difference. It must not invent an item count or a location.
- 19 **Ben:** Read-back: twelve cartons listed, eleven counted, contents unchecked, and no confirmed location for carton twelve. Have I missed anything?
- 20 **Priya:** Yes. That preserves the ¹⁰ _____ and the limits of our information. The discrepancy remains open until the relevant checks establish more.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. listed quantity | 2. short by | 3. quantity basis | 4. contents | 5. unlocated carton | 6. discrepancy | 7. joint count | 8. cause attribution | 9. dispatch follow-up | 10. physical count

Report another count difference

F Say it

At Cedar Supplies, the document lists nine cartons. Driver and receiver count eight. Contents are unchecked, and the ninth carton has no confirmed location.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

nine / one / unchecked / eight

Driver: "The document lists ¹ _____ cartons."

Receiver: "The physical count is ² _____ cartons."

Driver: "The shipment is short by ³ _____ carton."

Receiver: "The contents remain ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. nine | 2. eight | 3. one | 4. unchecked

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read twelve cartons listed and eleven cartons counted, then state one carton short.
2. Repeat the contents-unknown line without changing cartons into individual products.
3. Use turns 14 and 20 to keep the shared count separate from the unresolved cause.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An estimate after the cutoff

A Read the situation

03

Compare an estimated arrival with a receiving deadline and commit to a specific update without promising acceptance.

Driver Omar is safely parked and calls dispatcher Mei at 10:20. His current estimated arrival is 11:40, but the receiver stops accepting this delivery at 11:30. No later slot has been confirmed. Mei can contact receiving and update Omar by 10:40, even if the question remains unresolved. The conversation must preserve the ten-minute mismatch, distinguish the update deadline from arrival, and avoid implying that the driver should rush or exceed any applicable driving or working-time limits.

PEOPLE / Omar: Driver | Mei: Dispatcher

AN EARLY WARNING IS USEFUL BEFORE THERE IS A SOLUTION

A dispatcher needs the current estimate, the receiving constraint, and the next contact time. Report a likely mismatch plainly. Do not hide it inside an optimistic phrase such as nearly on time or turn a request for a later slot into an accepted appointment.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. When is arrival currently estimated?

A 11:30

B 11:40

C 10:20

D 10:40

2. How does the estimate compare with the cutoff?

A Ten minutes after it

B Ten minutes before it

C Exactly at it

D One hour before it

3. What can Mei commit to?

A An update by 10:40, even if unresolved

B Delivery by 10:40

C Automatic acceptance at 11:40

D A confirmed later slot already booked

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

03

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

estimated time of arrival

Provisional expected arrival time, commonly ETA.

IN USE update the estimated time of arrival

receiving cutoff

Latest stated time for accepting the delivery.

IN USE confirm the receiving cutoff

delivery window

Time range arranged or expected for a delivery.

IN USE clarify the delivery window

appointment slot

Specific time allocation that requires confirmation.

IN USE request an appointment slot

later slot

Receiving time after the original limit or booking.

IN USE ask about a later slot

time mismatch

Difference between an estimate and an applicable timing constraint.

IN USE report a time mismatch

status update

Message giving the current position of an issue.

IN USE provide a status update

update deadline

Latest time promised for the next communication.

IN USE state the update deadline

by

No later than a stated time.

IN USE update by 10:40

at

At a particular stated time.

IN USE call at 10:20

after

Later than a reference time.

IN USE arrive after the cutoff

before

Earlier than a reference time.

IN USE contact receiving before arrival

Precision check

At 10:20, the estimate is 11:40 and the cutoff is 11:30: a ten-minute mismatch. By 10:40 is the promised update deadline. None of those facts confirms permission to arrive after the cutoff.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

receiving confirmation

Explicit acceptance of the proposed receiving arrangement.

IN USE obtain receiving confirmation

provisional

Subject to change rather than guaranteed.

IN USE give a provisional estimate

revised estimate

Updated expectation based on current information.

IN USE issue a revised estimate

delay notification

Notice that timing may differ from the expected plan.

IN USE send a delay notification

schedule constraint

Limit affecting whether a proposed time is workable.

IN USE explain a schedule constraint

on duty

Working status relevant to actual driver rules and records.

IN USE clarify on-duty status

hours of service

Applicable limits and rest requirements governing covered drivers, often HOS.

IN USE follow hours-of-service requirements

driver availability

Whether a driver can lawfully and practically perform the proposed work.

IN USE verify driver availability

pending response

Reply that has not yet been received.

IN USE record a pending response

rescheduling request

Proposal to change the arranged time, not automatic acceptance.

IN USE submit a rescheduling request

confirmed appointment

Receiving arrangement explicitly agreed by the appropriate parties.

IN USE distinguish a confirmed appointment

UTC offset

Difference between local time and Coordinated Universal Time.

IN USE state the UTC offset

Precision check

A customer timing request does not override safe driving, actual working-time requirements, or carrier procedures. This lesson practices reporting the timing conflict and obtaining a decision; it supplies no instruction to change speed, rest, or duty records.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE CALL TIME

"It is 10:20, and I am parked for this call."

GIVE THE ESTIMATE

"My current estimated arrival is 11:40."

NAME THE CUTOFF

"Receiving has an 11:30 cutoff."

QUANTIFY THE MISMATCH

"That puts the estimate ten minutes after the cutoff."

AVOID MINIMIZING

"We should flag the mismatch now."

KEEP THE ESTIMATE PROVISIONAL

"11:40 is an estimate, not a guarantee."

ASK ABOUT CONFIRMATION

"Has receiving agreed to a later slot?"

STATE THE OPEN STATUS

"No later slot is confirmed yet."

By versus at

By gives a latest communication time; at names a particular time.

Estimated

Marks expected arrival as provisional rather than guaranteed.

Ten minutes after

Quantifies the mismatch without claiming acceptance.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASSIGN THE CONTACT

"I will contact receiving about the timing."

KEEP THE COMMITMENT EVEN IF UNRESOLVED

"You will hear from me even if their answer is still pending."

REJECT A FALSE APPOINTMENT

"A request for 11:40 is not a confirmed appointment."

AVOID PRESSURE TO RUSH

"We need a receiving decision, not a promise to make up time."

COMMIT TO AN UPDATE

"I will update you by 10:40."

DISTINGUISH THE TIMES

"10:40 is the update deadline, not the arrival time."

PROTECT THE FACTUAL RECORD

"Keep the 11:30 cutoff in the message."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"I own the receiving call and the next update."

Even if

Keeps the update commitment valid when the decision is unfinished.

Requested versus confirmed

A proposed later slot needs an actual accepting response.

Make up time

Can imply unsafe pressure; clarify the receiving plan instead.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which update is accurate?

- A** ETA 11:40; cutoff 11:30; later slot unconfirmed.
- B** ETA 10:40; cutoff extended automatically.
- C** Arrival guaranteed by 11:30.
- D** Receiving has accepted 11:40.

2. What does by 10:40 refer to?

- A** The time Omar must begin driving
- B** The deadline for Mei's update
- C** Guaranteed delivery completion
- D** A new receiving cutoff

3. Which sentence turns a request into a false result?

- A** I will ask whether a later slot is possible.
- B** Their response is still pending.
- C** I will update you even without a final answer.
- D** I will ask, so your 11:40 appointment is confirmed.

4. What should Omar do linguistically?

- A** Call the estimate a guarantee.
- B** Report the timing conflict without promising to rush.
- C** Promise to beat the estimate by any means.
- D** Omit the cutoff to sound reassuring.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

An estimate after the cutoff

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

update deadline / estimated time of arrival / by / time mismatch / status update / receiving cutoff / confirmed appointment / rescheduling request / driver availability / later slot

- 01 **Omar:** Mei, I'm parked for this call. It's ten twenty. My arrival estimate is eleven forty, but the receiving note looks earlier.
- 02 **Mei:** Their ¹ _____ is eleven thirty. That's ten minutes before your estimate, so we need a receiving decision.
- 03 **Omar:** That's why I'm calling now. I don't have anything confirming that they'll accept this delivery after eleven thirty.
- 04 **Mei:** I'll make a ² _____. For now I'll leave the eleven-thirty cutoff in the record, not replace it with your estimate.
- 05 **Omar:** Please make clear it's still an estimate. I don't want eleven forty going into their system as a guaranteed arrival.
- 06 **Mei:** Yes, your ³ _____ is eleven forty. I'll give them that and ask whether a later arrangement is possible.
- 07 **Omar:** When will you update me? Even a message saying you're still waiting would help me know where things stand.
- 08 **Mei:** I'll update you ⁴ _____ ten forty, whether or not they've decided. That's the latest time for my next message.
- 09 **Omar:** Good. If there's no answer from them, please say that explicitly. I won't read silence as permission for the later arrival.
- 10 **Mei:** You'll get a ⁵ _____ either way. If the request is still open, I'll say so.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Omar:** Ten minutes sounds small, but it still puts the estimate beyond their limit. We can't call that within the window.
- 12 **Mei:** Agreed. The ⁶ _____ stays in the message. Only the appropriate receiving decision can settle the scheduling question.
- 13 **Omar:** I also can't promise to make up those minutes on the road. We need a workable receiving plan.
- 14 **Mei:** Right. I'll keep ⁷ _____ and the applicable rules in view. This isn't a request to rush or change your duty record.
- 15 **Omar:** Has anyone else already spoken to them, or is the later time still entirely unconfirmed?
- 16 **Mei:** No ⁸ _____ is confirmed. I'll take that contact action and report their actual response.
- 17 **Omar:** Let me check the times: this call at ten twenty, arrival estimated eleven forty, and your message no later than ten forty.
- 18 **Mei:** Correct. My ⁹ _____ is ten forty. The receiving cutoff remains eleven thirty.
- 19 **Omar:** Thanks. I'll wait for that update without treating eleven forty as a booking. Keep the estimate and their cutoff separate.
- 20 **Mei:** I will. A ¹⁰ _____ still needs an accepted arrangement. I own the contact and the update by ten forty.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. receiving cutoff | 2. rescheduling request | 3. estimated time of arrival | 4. by | 5. status update | 6. time mismatch | 7. driver availability | 8. later slot | 9. update deadline | 10. confirmed appointment

Separate another estimate and update

F Say it

A parked driver calls at 13:00. Arrival is estimated at 14:20 and receiving closes for this delivery at 14:00. No later slot is agreed. Dispatcher Jo promises an update by 13:15.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

14:20 / twenty / unconfirmed / 13:15

Driver: "Estimated arrival is ¹ _____."

Dispatcher: "That is ² _____ minutes after the cutoff."

Driver: "Your update is due by ³ _____."

Dispatcher: "A later slot remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. 14:20 | 2. twenty | 3. 13:15 | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the four times in the case: call 10:20, ETA 11:40, cutoff 11:30, update by 10:40.
2. Repeat the by-10:40 commitment and stress that an unresolved answer still gets an update.
3. Read the driver-availability exchange without promising to recover time on the road.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A crushed corner is not a finding of fault

04

A Read the situation

Record visible packaging condition, attribute a customer concern, and resist unsupported conclusions about contents or responsibility.

At Grove Studio, receiver Ellis points out a crushed lower corner on one carton. Its contents remain unopened and uninspected. Ellis asks driver Nia to describe it as broken equipment caused by the driver. Nia can accurately report the visible crushed corner and the concern about possible internal damage, but neither internal damage nor its cause is established. The exchange ends with a factual description and a referral for follow-up, not a liability finding, claim approval, or decision about accepting the shipment.

PEOPLE / Ellis: Receiver | Nia: Driver

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN WITHOUT ADOPTING THE CONCLUSION

A customer may use strong causal language because the visible condition is upsetting. Show that you take the concern seriously while separating what is observable from what is alleged. Factual wording preserves the issue for proper review; it does not dismiss the customer.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is actually visible?

- A** A crushed lower corner on one carton
- B** Broken equipment inside every carton
- C** A driver dropping the carton
- D** Undamaged internal contents

2. What has not been checked?

- A** The contents
- B** The presence of the crushed corner
- C** The receiving business name
- D** The fact that a concern was raised

3. Which result is not established?

- A** A visible packaging concern
- B** A request for follow-up
- C** The lower-corner location
- D** Internal damage and its cause

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

delivery exception

Irregularity affecting a delivery; formal status meanings depend on the carrier.

IN USE report a delivery exception

external packaging

Outer material surrounding the shipped goods.

IN USE describe external packaging

crushed corner

Corner visibly compressed or deformed.

IN USE record the crushed corner

visible condition

State that can be directly observed.

IN USE report the visible condition

internal damage

Damage to goods inside the package.

IN USE distinguish internal damage

unopened carton

Outer box whose contents have not been accessed.

IN USE identify the unopened carton

inspection

Examination to establish condition or other facts.

IN USE request an inspection

condition notation

Written note describing observed condition.

IN USE make a condition notation

delivery receipt

Record associated with receiving a delivery.

IN USE review the delivery receipt

damage allegation

Statement claiming damage that requires factual evaluation.

IN USE attribute a damage allegation

attributed statement

Report clearly identified as someone else's account.

IN USE preserve an attributed statement

causal claim

Statement asserting what produced a result.

IN USE qualify a causal claim

Precision check

The supported description is one carton with a crushed lower corner, contents unopened and uninspected. The condition warrants reporting, but it does not establish broken equipment, a driver-caused event, claim approval, or liability.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fault

Responsibility for an event, not established by appearance alone.

IN USE avoid assigning fault

liability

Legal responsibility requiring the appropriate determination.

IN USE distinguish liability from observation

claim

Formal request for a remedy through the applicable process.

IN USE refer a claim

claim approval

Authorized acceptance of a claim, not merely its reporting.

IN USE avoid promising claim approval

concealed damage

Damage not apparent from external observation.

IN USE report suspected concealed damage

abrasion

Surface wear or scraping.

IN USE describe an abrasion

puncture

Hole made through packaging or material.

IN USE identify a puncture

tear

Split or rip in packaging material.

IN USE describe a tear

wet patch

Visible damp area without an established source.

IN USE note a wet patch

observation

Directly perceived fact rather than an inferred cause.

IN USE separate observation from inference

follow-up referral

Routing an issue for further review.

IN USE make a follow-up referral

acceptance decision

Decision about receiving the shipment under the actual process.

IN USE clarify the acceptance decision

Precision check

A receiver concern can be documented as a concern without being presented as a verified finding. Use precise location and packaging words, and follow the actual carrier process for condition records, inspections, acceptance decisions, and claims.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I can see why that corner concerns you."

LIMIT THE DESCRIPTION

"I am describing the external packaging."

AVOID FALSE REASSURANCE

"I cannot confirm that the equipment inside is undamaged."

SEPARATE CAUSE

"We have not established what caused the condition."

NAME THE OBSERVATION

"One carton has a crushed lower corner."

STATE THE INSPECTION STATUS

"The contents have not been inspected."

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED FINDING

"I cannot confirm that the equipment is broken either."

ATTRIBUTE THE CONCERN

"You are concerned that the equipment may be damaged."

May be

Presents a possibility, not a verified internal condition.

Caused by

Asserts a causal connection and needs evidence beyond appearance.

Concerned that

Attributes the worry without converting it into a finding.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REJECT AN INACCURATE NOTE

"I cannot record driver-caused damage as an established fact."

OFFER A FACTUAL SUMMARY

"Crushed lower corner; contents unopened and uninspected."

SEPARATE REPORTING AND APPROVAL

"Reporting the issue does not approve a claim."

PRESERVE THE LOCATION

"The lower corner, not the whole carton, is the observed area."

KEEP THE ISSUE VISIBLE

"The visible condition should be included in the report."

REFER THE MATTER

"I will refer the concern for follow-up through the carrier process."

AVOID DECIDING LIABILITY

"This conversation does not determine responsibility."

CLOSE WITHOUT OVERCLAIMING

"The condition is reported; the internal condition and cause remain unknown."

Visible versus concealed

Separates externally observable condition from what may be hidden.

Reported versus approved

Filing or routing a concern does not grant a remedy.

Neither conclusion

Uninspected means neither damaged nor undamaged is confirmed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which condition note matches the evidence?

- A** Contents inspected and confirmed undamaged.
- B** Every carton is crushed.
- C** One carton has a crushed lower corner; contents uninspected.
- D** Driver broke the equipment inside.

2. Which sentence acknowledges concern without asserting damage?

- A** Your concern is irrelevant because the carton is closed.
- B** You are concerned that the equipment may be damaged.
- C** The driver definitely broke your equipment.
- D** There cannot be any damage inside.

3. What does a follow-up referral establish?

- A** Legal liability has been decided.
- B** A refund has been authorized.
- C** The shipment must be accepted.
- D** The issue is being routed for review, not approved as a claim.

4. Which distinction separates the observed condition from the still-unchecked condition?

- A** One receiving entrance versus another receiving entrance.
- B** Claim approval versus payment of a claim.
- C** Packaging condition versus uninspected contents.
- D** This delivery date versus the previous delivery date.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

A crushed corner is not a finding of fault

04

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

follow-up referral / visible condition / Internal damage / inspection / attributed statement / liability / causal claim / claim approval / crushed corner / condition notation

- 01 **Ellis:** Look at this crushed corner. I want the receipt to say the driver broke the equipment; otherwise I'm worried nobody will take it seriously.
- 02 **Nia:** I will not ignore it. I can record the ¹ _____: one carton has a crushed lower corner. We have not opened it or inspected the equipment inside.
- 03 **Ellis:** It's a bad dent, though. This equipment matters to us, and I don't want the note to make the problem sound trivial.
- 04 **Nia:** The ² _____ should clearly describe the corner. Saying the contents are uninspected does not remove or minimize that visible concern.
- 05 **Ellis:** If you only mention the box, could someone read that as me agreeing the equipment is fine? I haven't opened it.
- 06 **Nia:** We can state the ³ _____ status explicitly. The contents are unopened and uninspected, so I cannot confirm that they are fine or that they are broken.
- 07 **Ellis:** Then say I'm concerned the equipment may be damaged. Keep that concern with the description of the lower corner.
- 08 **Nia:** Yes. That is an ⁴ _____: you are concerned about possible internal damage. It is different from recording confirmed broken equipment as an observed fact.
- 09 **Ellis:** I think it happened during delivery, although I didn't see it happen. Can you include what I think without calling it proved?
- 10 **Nia:** That would be a ⁵ _____ we have not established. I can report your concern, but I cannot state driver-caused damage as a verified conclusion.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Ellis:** You're not ruling out carrier responsibility either, are you? I don't want this careful wording to become a rejection of the concern.
- 12 **Nia:** Correct. I am not deciding ⁶ _____ in either direction. I am separating the observation from questions that need the appropriate review.
- 13 **Ellis:** Let's make the location exact: the lower corner of this carton. I'm not saying every carton has the same problem.
- 14 **Nia:** I will keep that precise: a ⁷ _____ on one carton, at the lower corner, with the contents still unopened and uninspected.
- 15 **Ellis:** Who will review it next? I'm asking for follow-up, not expecting you to promise a replacement on the spot.
- 16 **Nia:** I will make a ⁸ _____ through our carrier process. Reporting the issue does not itself approve a claim or decide how it will be resolved.
- 17 **Ellis:** Please refer it. I'll keep the packaging observation separate from whatever an inspection later finds inside.
- 18 **Nia:** That distinction matters. ⁹ _____ remains unverified. The packaging condition is visible, and both facts should remain in the report.
- 19 **Ellis:** All right. We've agreed what to report, but we haven't decided what caused it, what the equipment's condition is, or what happens with a claim.
- 20 **Nia:** Exactly. No ¹⁰ _____ or acceptance decision is made by this conversation. We have a clear condition report and a concern to refer.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. visible condition | 2. condition notation | 3. inspection | 4. attributed statement | 5. causal claim | 6. liability | 7. crushed corner | 8. follow-up referral | 9. Internal damage | 10. claim approval

Describe a different visible condition

F Say it

At Cedar Studio, one carton has a tear in its upper side panel. Contents are unopened and uninspected. The receiver fears internal damage, but neither damage inside nor its cause is established.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unopened / unverified / established / tear

Driver: "One carton has a ¹ _____ in its upper side panel."

Receiver: "The contents are still ² _____."

Driver: "Internal damage remains ³ _____."

Receiver: "The cause is not ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. tear | 2. unopened | 3. unverified | 4. established

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the condition note: one crushed lower corner, contents unopened and uninspected.
2. Repeat the receiver's concern with may, without converting it into a verified finding.
3. Read the referral lines while keeping liability, claim approval, and acceptance undecided.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The contact answers, but the office is closed

A Read the situation

05

Distinguish contact from availability, explain an unconfirmed wait, and refer delivery alternatives without inventing arrangements.

At 14:10, driver Sam is safely parked outside the closed receiving office of Marlow Design. Listed contact Lina answers the phone and says she can return at 15:00, fifty minutes later. Sam cannot commit to waiting until then. Dispatch can review redelivery; whether collection from a carrier location is available remains unknown. Nothing authorizes leaving the shipment unattended, marking it received, or promising a new slot. Sam and Lina clarify what dispatch needs to review.

PEOPLE / Sam: Delivery driver | Lina: Listed receiving contact

AN ANSWERED CALL IS NOT A SUCCESSFUL DELIVERY

A customer may reasonably hope that a return time solves the problem, but driver availability is a separate question. Acknowledge the proposed time, state the current limit clearly, and distinguish a reviewable option from a confirmed arrangement.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the situation at 14:10?

- A A new delivery appointment is booked
- C Lina is at the receiving desk

- B The receiving office is closed
- D The shipment has been received

2. When can Lina return?

- A Tomorrow at an agreed time
- C 14:15, five minutes later

- B 15:00, fifty minutes later
- D 14:10 immediately

3. Which alternative can be reviewed but is not confirmed?

- A Unattended delivery already authorized
- C Waiting until 15:00 already agreed

- B Collection definitely available
- D Redelivery through dispatch

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

recipient unavailable

Status indicating the intended receiver cannot currently receive.

IN USE report recipient unavailable

listed contact

Person named in the delivery contact information.

IN USE call the listed contact

receiving office

Office responsible for handling incoming deliveries.

IN USE check the receiving office

closed premises

Location not currently open for the relevant service.

IN USE report closed premises

dwelt time

Total elapsed time at a facility, with the measurement endpoints stated.

IN USE record the dwell time

contact attempt

Effort to reach the named recipient or contact.

IN USE record a contact attempt

answered call

Telephone contact successfully established.

IN USE distinguish an answered call

return time

Time when the contact expects to be back.

IN USE confirm the return time

waiting commitment

Agreement to remain until a specified time.

IN USE avoid an unconfirmed waiting commitment

redelivery

Another attempt to deliver the shipment.

IN USE request redelivery review

collection option

Possible arrangement to pick up goods at another location.

IN USE check the collection option

carrier location

Carrier-operated or approved place relevant to a shipment.

IN USE verify the carrier location

Precision check

Lina answers at 14:10 but cannot receive until 15:00. That is fifty minutes later, not a confirmed waiting arrangement. Dispatch can review redelivery; collection availability and any replacement slot are still unknown.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

unattended delivery

Leaving goods without an in-person receiving handover.

IN USE clarify unattended-delivery authorization

release authorization

Specific permission to release goods under the applicable process.

IN USE verify release authorization

delivery attempt

Visit or action aimed at delivery, not necessarily successful handover.

IN USE record the delivery attempt

received status

Record that the shipment has actually been received.

IN USE distinguish received status

no response

Contact outcome where no reply is obtained.

IN USE avoid an inaccurate no-response note

service availability

Whether the requested service can actually be offered.

IN USE confirm service availability

detention charge

Contract-dependent charge for delay beyond the allowed period.

IN USE explain the detention charge

dispatch review

Assessment by the team coordinating the delivery.

IN USE request dispatch review

new slot

Proposed replacement delivery time.

IN USE confirm a new slot

unconfirmed alternative

Possible option not yet agreed or available.

IN USE explain an unconfirmed alternative

contact outcome

Result of trying to reach the intended person.

IN USE document the contact outcome

follow-up owner

Person responsible for the next action or communication.

IN USE identify the follow-up owner

Precision check

Closed office, answered call, and uncompleted delivery are compatible facts. Do not record no response when the contact answered, or received when no handover occurred. Actual release, waiting, and redelivery decisions require the carrier process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE PRESENT POSITION

"I am outside the closed receiving office at 14:10."

ASK ABOUT AVAILABILITY

"When will someone be available to receive?"

QUANTIFY THE WAIT

"That would be fifty minutes from now."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE INCONVENIENCE

"I understand that this disrupts your plans."

CONFIRM THE CONTACT

"Am I speaking with the listed receiving contact?"

REPEAT THE RETURN TIME

"You can return at 15:00; is that correct?"

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED COMMITMENT

"I cannot commit to waiting until 15:00."

OFFER A REVIEW

"Dispatch can review a redelivery arrangement."

Can return

Describes the contact's availability, not the driver's waiting agreement.

Until

Gives the endpoint of a proposed wait.

Can review

Offers assessment without promising the outcome.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE REVIEW AND BOOKING

"No new slot is confirmed yet."

KEEP COLLECTION UNCERTAIN

"I do not yet know whether collection is available."

AVOID AN UNAUTHORIZED RELEASE

"No unattended release has been authorized."

PRESERVE THE CONTACT OUTCOME

"I reached the listed contact by phone."

PRESERVE THE DELIVERY STATUS

"The shipment has not been received."

CORRECT A FALSE INFERENCE

"Answering the phone does not mean someone is here to receive."

NAME THE NEXT ACTION

"I will send the current details to dispatch for review."

SUMMARIZE THE OPEN POSITION

"Return at 15:00; waiting and alternatives remain unconfirmed."

Not available versus unknown

Unknown collection availability is not a definite refusal of that option.

Attempted versus received

A delivery visit does not itself establish a completed handover.

Reached versus present

A person can answer remotely while the receiving office remains closed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which record preserves the facts?

- A** Driver agreed to wait until 15:00.
- B** Office closed at 14:10; contact answered and can return at 15:00.
- C** No response from the listed contact.
- D** Shipment received at 14:10.

2. Which response correctly addresses waiting?

- A** I have booked a fifty-minute wait.
- B** I will be waiting at 15:00 for your return.
- C** Dispatch has already agreed that I can stay.
- D** I cannot commit to waiting until 15:00.

3. Which collection statement is accurate?

- A** Collection is impossible at every carrier location.
- B** Your collection booking is complete.
- C** Collection availability has not been confirmed.
- D** You can definitely collect tonight.

4. What can happen next?

- A** Dispatch can review redelivery without promising a slot yet.
- B** Mark the shipment received to close the stop.
- C** Leave it unattended without authorization.
- D** Promise a new time before dispatch responds.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The contact answers, but the office is closed

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

dispatch review / return time / listed contact / release authorization / service availability /
redelivery / contact outcome / unconfirmed alternative / collection option / received status

- 01 **Sam:** Hello, I'm safely parked outside Marlow Design. It's fourteen ten, and the receiving office is closed. Is this Lina?
- 02 **Lina:** Yes, I'm the ¹ _____. I'm away from the office. I can be back at fifteen hundred; could you wait?
- 03 **Sam:** That's fifty minutes from now. I understand you'd like to receive it today, but I can't commit to waiting until then.
- 04 **Lina:** I thought giving you my ² _____ would solve it. I hadn't checked whether that would work with your route.
- 05 **Sam:** I can pass the details to dispatch for a redelivery review. I don't have a new slot to offer on this call.
- 06 **Lina:** Would ³ _____ mean another visit today? I'd need to know before asking someone else to stay late.
- 07 **Sam:** It hasn't been scheduled. Dispatch needs to review what can be offered; I can't promise today or tomorrow.
- 08 **Lina:** Could there be a ⁴ _____ instead? I might be able to pick it up later.
- 09 **Sam:** I don't know whether that's available for this shipment. Please don't travel to a carrier location before it's checked.
- 10 **Lina:** Then please include that ⁵ _____ question as well. I'd like them to check collection, not just another delivery.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Sam:** I'll pass on both. For the stop record, I've reached you by phone, but no one is here to receive the goods.
- 12 **Lina:** Yes, don't mark it with a ⁶ _____. I've answered remotely; I haven't taken delivery.
- 13 **Sam:** And I won't mark the call no response. The office is closed, but we did speak and you gave me a return time.
- 14 **Lina:** That's the correct ⁷ _____. Please make sure dispatch sees that we spoke.
- 15 **Sam:** I will. I also haven't been authorized to leave the shipment unattended. Your return time doesn't change that.
- 16 **Lina:** Understood. No ⁸ _____ has been arranged here. Please send the situation for review.
- 17 **Sam:** I'll report office closed at fourteen ten, contact reached, return possible at fifteen hundred, and no commitment to wait.
- 18 **Lina:** And the ⁹ _____ will cover redelivery and whether collection is possible? Those are the two questions I want answered.
- 19 **Sam:** Yes. Neither is confirmed, and I don't have a collection address or new delivery time to give you yet.
- 20 **Lina:** Thank you. I'll treat each ¹⁰ _____ as a question to check. My return time is fifteen hundred, not an agreed delivery solution.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. listed contact | 2. return time | 3. redelivery | 4. collection option | 5. service availability | 6. received status | 7. contact outcome | 8. release authorization | 9. dispatch review | 10. unconfirmed alternative

Clarify another closed-office call

F Say it

At 09:20, a driver reaches the contact for a closed office. The contact can return at 10:00. Waiting cannot be promised; dispatch can review redelivery, and collection availability is unknown.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

forty / confirmed / answered / unknown

Driver: "Your return would be ¹ _____ minutes from now."

Contact: "The phone call was ² _____."

Driver: "Waiting is not ³ _____."

Contact: "Collection availability is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. forty | 2. answered | 3. confirmed | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read 14:10 and 15:00, then say fifty minutes without implying a waiting agreement.
2. Repeat the contact outcome: call answered, office closed, no goods received.
3. Read the two review questions: redelivery and collection availability.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Curbside is not upstairs placement

A Read the situation

Explain the booked service, acknowledge a different need, and route a change request without promising price or timing.

Customer Rafael expects a household delivery to be carried upstairs. Driver Amara checks the booking, which specifies curbside delivery and does not include inside service. Amara cannot add upstairs placement. Dispatch can review a possible upgrade or rearrangement, but no availability, price, or timing is known. Rafael asks for that review. The conversation does not authorize an immediate service change, direct the customer to move the goods, or establish that any shipment has been unloaded or accepted.

PEOPLE / Rafael: Customer | Amara: Delivery driver

06

EXPLAIN THE BOUNDARY WITHOUT BLAMING THE CUSTOMER

A customer may use delivery to mean placement in the room where an item will be used. Name the actual booked service and acknowledge the mismatch. Offer a specific route for review without implying that personal effort or an unapproved payment can change the booking.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What service is booked?

- A Upstairs room placement
- C Inside delivery with unpacking

- B Assembly and installation
- D Curbside delivery

2. What does Rafael request?

- A Cancellation already agreed
- C Upstairs placement

- B Collection from a depot
- D A different shipment reference

3. What is known about a possible change?

- A It is free and immediate
- C A new appointment is booked

- B The driver has approved it
- D Dispatch can review it; availability, price, and timing are unknown

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

curbside delivery

Service to the agreed curbside point under the actual booking.

IN USE confirm curbside delivery

inside delivery

Service bringing goods inside under specified terms.

IN USE distinguish inside delivery

upstairs placement

Positioning goods on an upper floor.

IN USE request upstairs placement

room-of-choice service

Delivery to a specified room when that service is offered and agreed.

IN USE check room-of-choice service

booked service

Service actually recorded in the confirmed booking.

IN USE verify the booked service

service scope

Work included and excluded in the agreed arrangement.

IN USE explain the service scope

service boundary

Limit of what the current arrangement authorizes.

IN USE state the service boundary

upgrade request

Proposal to change to an additional or higher service level.

IN USE submit an upgrade request

rearrangement

Change to delivery arrangements requiring confirmation.

IN USE discuss a rearrangement

availability check

Verification that a requested service can be supplied.

IN USE request an availability check

quotation

Stated price for specified work and conditions.

IN USE obtain a quotation

accessorial charge

Additional freight-service charge under applicable terms.

IN USE clarify an accessorial charge

Precision check

Curbside delivery is the booked service in this fictional case; upstairs placement is a different request. No general definition here overrides an actual contract. Review by dispatch does not establish that an upgrade exists or that it is free.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

price confirmation

Verification of the actual amount for the proposed service.

IN USE await price confirmation

timing confirmation

Verification of when an agreed service can occur.

IN USE await timing confirmation

authorization

Permission from the appropriate decision-maker for a specific action.

IN USE obtain authorization

service amendment

Approved change to the recorded service arrangement.

IN USE confirm a service amendment

scope mismatch

Difference between the booked work and the requested work.

IN USE explain the scope mismatch

customer expectation

What the customer believes the service will include.

IN USE clarify the customer expectation

access requirement

Site or access detail relevant to reviewing the requested service.

IN USE confirm access requirements

stair carry

Carrying goods on stairs as a separately defined service where offered.

IN USE ask about stair-carry service

assembly

Putting product parts together, distinct from delivery.

IN USE distinguish assembly from delivery

installation

Setting up a product for use under the relevant service.

IN USE distinguish installation from placement

unloading status

Whether unloading has occurred, separate from discussion of scope.

IN USE clarify the unloading status

change acceptance

Customer agreement to a specific confirmed proposal.

IN USE obtain change acceptance

Precision check

Price, availability, timing, and authorization are separate questions. A customer can ask for a review without accepting an unknown charge or an unconfirmed date. This dialogue provides no handling instructions or permission to unload or move the shipment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXPECTATION

"I understand you expected the item upstairs."

EXPLAIN THE EXCLUSION

"Inside service is not included in this booking."

AVOID BLAME

"Let us clarify the difference between the booking and the request."

KEEP AVAILABILITY OPEN

"I do not yet know whether that service can be offered."

NAME THE BOOKING

"The booking specifies curbside delivery."

STATE YOUR AUTHORITY

"I cannot add upstairs placement myself."

OFFER A REVIEW

"Dispatch can review an upgrade or rearrangement."

KEEP PRICE OPEN

"No upgrade price has been confirmed."

06

Booked versus expected

Separates the recorded arrangement from the customer's understanding.

Included

States the scope of this booking, not every service offered by the carrier.

Can review versus can provide

Assessment is possible even when availability remains unknown.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP TIMING OPEN

"No revised delivery time is confirmed."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND APPROVAL

"Asking for review does not approve the service change."

PRESERVE THE CHOICE

"You have not accepted an unknown price."

KEEP THE SHIPMENT STATUS SEPARATE

"We are discussing scope, not confirming unloading."

CLARIFY THE REQUEST

"Would you like me to refer the upstairs-placement request?"

AVOID AN UNAPPROVED PAYMENT

"I cannot agree to an informal extra charge."

AVOID EXPANDING THE SCOPE

"Placement, assembly, and installation are different services."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"I will send the request to dispatch for a checked response."

06

Myself

Marks the driver's authority limit without claiming no alternative exists.

Upgrade versus authorization

Naming an option does not make it approved.

Unknown price

Cannot be treated as accepted merely because the customer requests a review.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which response explains the boundary accurately?

- A** Curbside also means installation in every contract.
- B** Curbside is booked; upstairs placement needs separate review.
- C** All deliveries automatically include upstairs placement.
- D** Upstairs placement is already approved.

2. Which price statement is supported?

- A** Rafael has accepted any amount.
- B** No upgrade price has been confirmed.
- C** The upgrade is definitely free.
- D** The driver can name an informal price.

3. What does Rafael's review request authorize in the dialogue?

- A** Referring the request to dispatch, not performing the upgrade.
- B** Immediate upstairs placement.
- C** Automatic assembly and installation.
- D** Treating unloading as completed.

4. Which summary keeps all uncertainties?

- A** The customer must move the goods upstairs personally.
- B** Upgrade availability, price, and timing remain unknown.
- C** Only timing is unknown; everything else is approved.
- D** The service has been amended and accepted.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Curbside is not upstairs placement

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Assembly / authorization / change acceptance / service scope / upgrade request / timing confirmation / quotation / booked service / service amendment / scope mismatch

06

- 01 **Rafael:** I need it upstairs in my apartment. When I booked delivery, I thought that meant bringing it to the room where I'll use it.
- 02 **Amara:** I understand the expectation. The ¹ _____ here is curbside delivery. This booking does not include inside service or upstairs placement.
- 03 **Rafael:** That's a problem. Can the upstairs part be added now? I wasn't planning for the item to stop outside.
- 04 **Amara:** I cannot make that ² _____ myself. Dispatch can review an upgrade or rearrangement, but I do not have an approved change to carry out.
- 05 **Rafael:** Do you mean the carrier never offers upstairs delivery, or just that it isn't part of the service I've booked?
- 06 **Amara:** I am explaining the ³ _____ of this booking. Whether another service can be offered needs checking, so I should not give you a definite yes or no yet.
- 07 **Rafael:** Would it cost extra? Please don't take my asking as agreement to whatever the price turns out to be.
- 08 **Amara:** No ⁴ _____ has been provided. You have not accepted an unknown price simply by asking what alternatives might be available.
- 09 **Rafael:** And could it happen today? I need to check both the price and the date before deciding.
- 10 **Amara:** I have no ⁵ _____ either. Availability, price, and timing all need a checked response before you can assess a specific proposal.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Rafael:** Please ask dispatch. Make the request specific: upstairs placement, not just customer unhappy with delivery.
- 12 **Amara:** I can send an ⁶ _____ for upstairs placement. I will explain that curbside is booked and that you want them to review a different arrangement.
- 13 **Rafael:** I don't need assembly or installation considered at this point. First I need to know whether the item can be placed upstairs.
- 14 **Amara:** Understood. ⁷ _____ is separate from placement, and I will not expand your request into installation or other work you have not asked about.
- 15 **Rafael:** I want it handled through the booking, not an informal arrangement. I need a clear record of what's included.
- 16 **Amara:** That requires the proper ⁸ _____ and a confirmed arrangement. I cannot agree to an informal extra charge or treat that as a replacement for the process.
- 17 **Rafael:** So I'll get the actual proposal before deciding? There isn't a confirmed extra service or charge for me to accept yet.
- 18 **Amara:** Yes. Your ⁹ _____ would concern a specific proposed service, price, and timing. At present those details remain unknown.
- 19 **Rafael:** Please pass that on. We've discussed what I wanted, but nothing here says the upgrade or unloading has happened.
- 20 **Amara:** I will. The ¹⁰ _____ is clear, and I will refer it to dispatch. This conversation does not confirm an upgrade or any completed unloading.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. booked service | 2. service amendment | 3. service scope | 4. quotation | 5. timing confirmation | 6. upgrade request | 7. Assembly | 8. authorization | 9. change acceptance | 10. scope mismatch

Refer another service-change request

F Say it

A household booking specifies curbside delivery. The customer requests room-of-choice placement. The driver cannot add it; dispatch can review it, with price and timing still unknown.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

curbside / unknown / dispatch / room-of-choice

Driver: "The booked service is ¹ _____ delivery."

Customer: "I am requesting ² _____ placement."

Driver: "The proposed change needs ³ _____ review."

Customer: "The price and timing remain ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. curbside | 2. room-of-choice | 3. dispatch | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Contrast booked curbside delivery with requested upstairs placement in turns 2 and 12.
2. Read price, availability, and timing as three unanswered questions.
3. Repeat the review request without adding assembly, installation, or an informal charge.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two booked cartons and one extra

A Read the situation

Match goods to a return reference, isolate an unmatched item, and request clarification without silently expanding the collection.

Driver Kai arrives for return collection R62, which lists two printer cartons. Customer Dana presents those two identifiable cartons and a third carton of cables without a matching collection reference. Dispatch can query the extra carton, but no authorization to add it has been received. The two printer cartons remain identifiable under R62. The conversation establishes the mismatch and next query; it does not confirm that any carton has been loaded, collected, rejected permanently, or credited to the customer.

PEOPLE / Kai: Driver | Dana: Customer

07

SEPARATE THE EXTRA ITEM FROM THE VALID REFERENCE

A customer may reasonably group related equipment together, while the collection record identifies a narrower set. Explain which items match and which item needs clarification. Avoid turning one unmatched carton into a claim that the entire collection is invalid.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does R62 list?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Two printer cartons | B Three cable cartons |
| C One printer and one cable carton | D Two cable cartons and one printer carton |

2. Which item lacks a matching reference?

- | | |
|--|-------------------------------------|
| A Both identified printer cartons | B The R62 document itself |
| C The second printer carton | D The third carton of cables |

3. What is established by the discussion?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A A customer credit has been approved | B The mismatch and a dispatch query, not completed collection |
| C All three cartons have been loaded | D The extra carton is permanently rejected |

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

return reference

Identifier connecting goods to a particular return arrangement.

IN USE confirm the return reference

collection booking

Recorded arrangement for picking up specified goods.

IN USE check the collection booking

return authorization

Approval for specified goods to be returned under stated conditions.

IN USE verify return authorization

return merchandise authorization

Formal return identifier or process, commonly RMA.

IN USE quote the return merchandise authorization

matching reference

Identifier consistent with the relevant record.

IN USE locate a matching reference

unmatched item

Item not linked to the stated collection record.

IN USE isolate the unmatched item

printer carton

Outer box identified as containing a printer in the return description.

IN USE identify the printer carton

cable carton

Outer box presented as containing cables.

IN USE distinguish the cable carton

additional carton

Box presented beyond the recorded collection quantity.

IN USE query the additional carton

booked quantity

Number of units specified in the collection arrangement.

IN USE preserve the booked quantity

presented quantity

Number of units offered by the customer at collection.

IN USE compare the presented quantity

collection scope

Items included in the specific pickup arrangement.

IN USE clarify the collection scope

Precision check

R62 matches two printer cartons. Three cartons are presented, but the cable carton has no matching reference. The extra-item query should not change the original two-carton description or make the two identified cartons disappear from the record.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

reference match

Confirmed correspondence between an item and a record identifier.

IN USE establish a reference match

return label

Label linking a package to return-shipping information.

IN USE check the return label

serial number

Identifier assigned to a particular individual product.

IN USE verify the serial number

item description

Recorded wording identifying the type of goods.

IN USE compare the item description

packing description

Account of how goods are grouped or packaged.

IN USE confirm the packing description

collection amendment

Approved change to the pickup arrangement.

IN USE request a collection amendment

query

Request for clarification, not an approved change.

IN USE raise a query

item separation

Keeping matched and unmatched items distinct in the discussion.

IN USE maintain item separation

loaded status

Record that goods have been placed on the vehicle.

IN USE distinguish loaded status

collected status

Record that a pickup has actually occurred.

IN USE verify collected status

credit approval

Authorized financial credit, separate from return collection.

IN USE distinguish credit approval

return disposition

Decision about what happens to returned goods under the actual process.

IN USE await return disposition

Precision check

A collection reference, a product serial number, and a return authorization may serve different purposes. Use the actual records required by the carrier and customer process. A reference match alone does not prove loading, pickup, refund, or credit completion.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE BOOKING

"I am here for return collection R62."

CONFIRM THE MATCHED ITEMS

"These two printer cartons match R62."

IDENTIFY THE MISSING LINK

"I do not have a matching reference for that carton."

ASK FOR CLARIFICATION

"Is there a separate collection reference for the cables?"

STATE THE BOOKED COUNT

"The booking lists two printer cartons."

NAME THE ADDITIONAL ITEM

"The third carton contains cables according to your description."

KEEP THE SETS SEPARATE

"The original two are identifiable; the cable carton is the open question."

AVOID SILENT EXPANSION

"I cannot treat R62 as a three-carton booking without confirmation."

07

Additional

Identifies the carton beyond the original two, not a substitute for them.

Match

Connects a specific item and record rather than similar-looking goods.

Related versus included

Cables may relate to printers without belonging to the same booking.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REFER THE QUERY

"Dispatch can query the additional carton."

AVOID PERMANENT REJECTION

"Unmatched does not mean permanently rejected."

DISTINGUISH STATUS

"Matching the reference does not mean the goods are already collected."

READ BACK THE DIFFERENCE

"Two booked, three presented, with one unmatched cable carton."

KEEP APPROVAL PENDING

"No collection amendment has been authorized yet."

PRESERVE THE ITEM DESCRIPTION

"Two printer cartons, not three printer cartons."

AVOID A CREDIT PROMISE

"This check does not approve a customer credit."

CLOSE WITH THE EXACT QUERY

"The next question is whether the cable carton has an authorized collection arrangement."

Query versus amendment

Asking about an extra item does not alter the collection record.

Identifiable versus collected

A successful match is not a completed pickup.

Return versus credit

Moving goods back does not itself establish a financial remedy.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back is accurate?

- A** R62 lists two printer cartons; the cable carton is unmatched.
- B** R62 lists three printer cartons.
- C** No carton matches any record.
- D** The cable carton has already been added.

2. Which action is available in the conversation?

- A** Declare a customer credit approved.
- B** Mark all three cartons collected.
- C** Ask dispatch to query the extra carton.
- D** Invent a matching reference.

3. Which statement goes too far?

- A** The cable carton lacks a matching reference.
- B** The original two printer cartons remain identifiable.
- C** No amendment is authorized yet.
- D** The unmatched carton is permanently rejected.

4. Which status distinction is essential?

- A** Related equipment always shares one booking.
- B** A query automatically approves an extra carton.
- C** Reference matched is not the same as collection completed.
- D** Any return automatically creates a refund.

[Answers and explanations: page 97.](#)

Two booked cartons and one extra

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cable carton / collection scope / matching reference / collection amendment / unmatched item / collected status / credit approval / booked quantity / return reference / collection booking

07

- 01 **Kai:** I'm here for return R62. It lists two printer cartons, but there are three cartons ready here. Could we check which is which?
- 02 **Dana:** These two are the printers. The third is a ¹ _____. I packed the cables separately because they go with the printers.
- 03 **Kai:** The two printer cartons match R62. I don't have a matching collection reference for the cables.
- 04 **Dana:** I thought the ² _____ covered everything we were returning together. Does that not include this separate box?
- 05 **Kai:** Not on the record I've got. We need to check the extra carton rather than quietly change a two-carton collection to three.
- 06 **Dana:** I don't have a ³ _____ for that one. Can you ask dispatch whether it's covered by another arrangement?
- 07 **Kai:** Yes. I'll give them the cable description and explain that the printers match but the extra box doesn't have a reference here.
- 08 **Dana:** Please keep the ⁴ _____ as two printer cartons while they check. There aren't three printers.
- 09 **Kai:** Exactly. Two printer cartons linked to R62, plus one separate carton you've described as cables.
- 10 **Dana:** Does the extra box cancel the whole ⁵ _____, or can the record still show which two match?

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Kai:** The original two are still identifiable under R62. It's the additional cable carton that needs clarification.
- 12 **Dana:** Good. I don't want each printer labelled an ⁶ _____ because I've brought out an extra box.
- 13 **Kai:** I won't do that. I'll keep the matches and the extra-item query separate. Dispatch hasn't authorized adding the cables yet.
- 14 **Dana:** So any ⁷ _____ is still pending. Asking you about the box hasn't changed the booking.
- 15 **Kai:** Correct. It's a query, not an approved addition. It also isn't a permanent rejection of the cable carton.
- 16 **Dana:** And no ⁸ _____ yet. We're still checking the paperwork, not saying you've taken any of these cartons.
- 17 **Kai:** Right. A reference match, loading, and a completed pickup are different stages. We've only clarified the identity question here.
- 18 **Dana:** It isn't ⁹ _____ either, then. I'll avoid telling accounts that a return check means the credit has gone through.
- 19 **Kai:** Yes. My report is R62, two identified printer cartons, one additional cable carton without a matching reference, query to dispatch.
- 20 **Dana:** That's accurate. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ clear while you ask about the cables. Don't change the description to three printers.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. cable carton | 2. return reference | 3. matching reference | 4. booked quantity | 5. collection booking | 6. unmatched item | 7. collection amendment | 8. collected status | 9. credit approval | 10. collection scope

Match another return accurately

F Say it

Return S73 lists three monitor cartons. The customer presents those three and an extra keyboard carton without a matching reference. Dispatch can query the extra item; no amendment or collection is confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

completed / keyboard / monitor / unmatched

Driver: "S73 lists three ¹ _____ cartons."

Customer: "The extra carton contains a ² _____."

Driver: "The extra carton remains ³ _____."

Customer: "The query does not mean collection is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. monitor | 2. keyboard | 3. unmatched | 4. completed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read R62 with two printer cartons, then identify the additional cable carton.
2. Repeat the distinction between two matched cartons and one unmatched carton.
3. Read the closing lines without claiming a pickup, booking amendment, or financial credit.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One missing upload, one refusal

A Read the situation

Hand over distinct delivery outcomes and unfinished records, attributing a reported reason and assigning each follow-up explicitly.

Route 12 is ending. Driver Luis tells evening dispatcher Jo that stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05, but the receipt has not uploaded. Stop 8 was refused because the customer reported a duplicate order; that reported reason has not been independently verified. Jo accepts responsibility for checking the stop-7 receipt upload and contacting customer service about stop 8. Neither follow-up is completed during this handover, and no refund, replacement delivery, or final route closure is established.

PEOPLE / Luis: Driver | Jo: Evening dispatcher

08

NAME THE OUTCOME, THE UNFINISHED RECORD, AND THE OWNER

End-of-route summaries often compress different problems into everything is done or two failed deliveries. Separate the physical outcome from the record status at each stop. Attribute the stated reason for a refusal and confirm the next person owns the remaining work.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What happened at stop 7?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Customer service approved a refund | B The customer refused a duplicate order |
| C Mei received the shipment at 16:05, but the receipt upload is missing | D Nobody received the shipment |

2. What is the known reason given at stop 8?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A The driver delivered to the wrong address | B The receipt upload failed at stop 7 |
| C The customer reported a duplicate order | D A duplicate order was independently proved |

3. What does Jo accept?

- | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|
| A Proof that the route is fully closed | B Both unfinished follow-ups |
| C A completed refund | D A new delivery appointment |

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

route handoff

Transfer of route information and unfinished responsibilities.

IN USE give a route handoff

route closure

Completion of the required route-ending process.

IN USE verify route closure

stop outcome

What actually happened at an individual delivery stop.

IN USE state the stop outcome

received by

Phrase naming the person who received goods.

IN USE record received by Mei

receipt timestamp

Time associated with the receiving event.

IN USE preserve the receipt timestamp

delivery receipt

Record associated with the receiving event.

IN USE locate the delivery receipt

proof of delivery

Evidence of delivery under the applicable process, often POD.

IN USE check proof of delivery

receipt upload

Transfer of the receipt into the required electronic system.

IN USE verify the receipt upload

upload pending

Status indicating the electronic transfer is unfinished.

IN USE report upload pending

synchronization

Updating records between devices or systems.

IN USE check synchronization status

record completeness

Whether all required information and records are present.

IN USE verify record completeness

missing document

Required record not currently available where expected.

IN USE follow up a missing document

08

Precision check

Stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05; its receipt upload is missing. Stop 8 was refused with a customer-reported duplicate-order reason. These are different outcomes, not two undelivered shipments or two completed follow-ups.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

refused delivery

Delivery the intended receiving party declines to accept.

IN USE record a refused delivery

refusal reason

Explanation given for declining a delivery.

IN USE attribute the refusal reason

reported duplicate

Alleged repetition of an order, not independently verified here.

IN USE record the reported duplicate

customer service

Team handling customer queries and resolution processes.

IN USE contact customer service

independent verification

Check separate from the original person's statement.

IN USE request independent verification

open item

Task or question still needing action.

IN USE list the open items

action owner

Person responsible for the next defined task.

IN USE name the action owner

ownership acceptance

Agreement to take responsibility for follow-up.

IN USE confirm ownership acceptance

completion status

Whether a task has actually been finished.

IN USE preserve completion status

route summary

Concise account of outcomes across a delivery route.

IN USE provide a route summary

read-back confirmation

Repetition that checks the accuracy of a handoff.

IN USE request read-back confirmation

resolution

Established outcome addressing an open issue.

IN USE distinguish referral from resolution

08

Precision check

Jo accepting responsibility changes who owns the next actions, not whether the actions are finished. A reported duplicate is not an independently confirmed duplicate, and a missing upload is not proof that the physical receiving event never happened.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE ROUTE

"I am handing over the open items from route 12."

SEPARATE THE STOPS

"Stop 7 and stop 8 have different issues."

STATE THE RECEIVING EVENT

"Mei received stop 7 at 16:05."

STATE THE MISSING RECORD

"The receipt has not uploaded."

AVOID A FALSE DELIVERY FAILURE

"The missing upload does not mean the goods were not received."

GIVE THE SECOND OUTCOME

"Stop 8 was refused."

ATTRIBUTE THE REASON

"The customer reported a duplicate order."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"That reason has not been independently verified."

Received versus uploaded

The physical event and electronic record transfer are separate facts.

Reported

Attributes the duplicate-order explanation to the customer.

Because

Can state the customer's reason for refusal without proving the underlying duplicate.



Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASSIGN THE FIRST ACTION

"Please check the stop-7 receipt upload."

ACCEPT OWNERSHIP

"I will take both follow-ups."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Please repeat the two actions and their current status."

PRESERVE THE TIMESTAMP

"Keep 16:05 with the stop-7 receiving record."

ASSIGN THE SECOND ACTION

"Please contact customer service about stop 8."

AVOID FALSE COMPLETION

"Taking ownership does not complete either check."

KEEP REMEDIES UNCONFIRMED

"No refund or replacement delivery is confirmed."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Jo owns both open items; their outcomes remain pending."

08

Will check versus checked

Future action must not be written as completed verification.

Both

Applies to the two distinct follow-ups, not two identical delivery outcomes.

Closed

Requires actual route-closeout conditions, not merely a handoff conversation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which stop-7 statement is accurate?

- A** Received by Mei at 16:05; receipt upload pending.
- B** Not received because the receipt is missing.
- C** Received by Jo at 15:06.
- D** Refused because of a verified duplicate.

2. Which stop-8 wording preserves attribution?

- A** A duplicate was independently verified.
- B** Stop 8 was successfully received.
- C** The customer reported a duplicate order and refused the delivery.
- D** The carrier definitely created a duplicate order.

3. Which handoff wrongly claims completion?

- A** Customer-service contact is still pending.
- B** No refund is confirmed.
- C** Jo accepted the tasks, so both issues are resolved.
- D** Jo will check the receipt upload.

4. Which action pair belongs to Jo?

- A** Change both stops to undelivered.
- B** Check stop-7 receipt upload and contact customer service about stop 8.
- C** Deliver both shipments again automatically.
- D** Approve a refund and delete the receipt time.

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

One missing upload, one refusal

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

receipt timestamp / Independent verification / stop outcome / customer service / Route closure /
receipt upload / refusal reason / action owner / read-back confirmation / Record completeness

08

- 01 **Luis:** Jo, I've got two open items from route twelve before I finish. Stop seven is a receipt issue; stop eight is a refusal.
- 02 **Jo:** Go ahead. Start with the ¹ _____ for stop 7, then tell me what remains unfinished. I do not want to merge it with stop 8.
- 03 **Luis:** Mei received stop seven at sixteen oh five. The receipt hasn't uploaded, so you won't find the completed electronic record yet.
- 04 **Jo:** I will check the ² _____. The receiving event is recorded as Mei at 16:05, and the missing upload is the follow-up issue.
- 05 **Luis:** Yes. Please don't mark that stop undelivered just because the upload is missing. The goods were received by Mei.
- 06 **Jo:** Understood. ³ _____ is still in question, but the missing document does not erase your report that Mei received the shipment.
- 07 **Luis:** At stop eight, the customer refused it and said the order was a duplicate. I haven't independently checked whether that's true.
- 08 **Jo:** I will keep the ⁴ _____ attributed to the customer. The wording should not become a finding that our company created a duplicate.
- 09 **Luis:** Please have customer service review that account. I didn't agree a refund or promise that we'd deliver it again.
- 10 **Jo:** I will contact ⁵ _____ about stop 8. No refund, replacement delivery, or other resolution is confirmed by this handoff.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Luis:** Can you take both jobs: checking the stop-seven upload and contacting customer service about the stop-eight refusal?
- 12 **Jo:** Yes, I am the ⁶ _____ for both follow-ups. I have accepted the tasks; I have not yet checked the upload or made the customer-service contact.
- 13 **Luis:** Thanks. Keep sixteen oh five with Mei at stop seven. It isn't the refusal time for stop eight.
- 14 **Jo:** I will preserve that ⁷ _____ exactly. We have no supplied time for the stop-8 refusal, so I will not copy 16:05 onto it.
- 15 **Luis:** Could you read the two notes back before I leave? I want the different outcomes and next actions kept together correctly.
- 16 **Jo:** Here is the ⁸ _____: stop 7 received by Mei at 16:05, upload pending; stop 8 refused for a customer-reported duplicate order. I own both follow-ups.
- 17 **Luis:** That's it. The duplicate is what the customer reported, not a verified ordering error. Both follow-ups are still outstanding.
- 18 **Jo:** Agreed. ⁹ _____ of the duplicate is still absent. The receipt check and customer-service contact remain pending.
- 19 **Luis:** Then the handover's clear. I won't call the whole route closed just because you've agreed to take the follow-ups.
- 20 **Jo:** Correct. ¹⁰ _____ is not established here. We have transferred the two open items with their facts, uncertainties, and next owner intact.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. stop outcome | 2. receipt upload | 3. Record completeness | 4. refusal reason | 5. customer service | 6. action owner | 7. receipt timestamp | 8. read-back confirmation | 9. Independent verification | 10. Route closure

Hand over another pair of stops

F Say it

On route 15, stop 3 was received by Noor at 12:25, but its receipt upload is pending. Stop 4 was refused after a customer reported an unwanted order. Dispatcher Ana accepts both follow-ups; neither is complete.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / reported / Ana / Noor

08

Driver: "Stop 3 was received by ¹ _____ at 12:25."

Dispatcher: "The receipt upload remains ² _____."

Driver: "The unwanted-order reason was ³ _____ by the customer."

Dispatcher: "The next action owner is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. Noor | 2. pending | 3. reported | 4. Ana

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read stop 7 with Mei at 16:05 and the separate pending receipt upload.
2. Read stop 8 with the customer's reported duplicate reason, without calling it verified.
3. Repeat Jo's two follow-ups and leave both marked unfinished.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Whose nine thirty?

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Read back an appointment with its date and time zone, then compare an arrival estimate on the same clock.

Fictional shipment T84: receiving confirms 13 October 2026 at 09:30 Central Daylight Time (CDT, UTC-5). Dispatch uses Eastern Daylight Time (EDT, UTC-4). The parked driver's current ETA is 10:15 EDT that day. The gate requires its actual check-in process; no early entry is promised. Priya and Joel clarify the shared record.

PEOPLE / Priya: Driver | Joel: Dispatcher

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

CDT / time zone / fifteen / check-in procedure / 10:30 / UTC

- 01 **Priya:** I'm parked and checking T84. The appointment says nine thirty, but my dispatch screen uses Eastern time. Which clock does the booking mean?
- 02 **Joel:** Receiving confirmed nine thirty ¹ _____, Central Daylight Time, on thirteen October. That is their local appointment time.
- 03 **Priya:** Their offset is UTC minus five, and our Eastern daylight setting is UTC minus four. So our clock is an hour ahead of theirs.
- 04 **Joel:** Correct. The same appointment is ² _____ on the Eastern daylight clock. Don't replace the label and keep nine thirty unchanged.
- 05 **Priya:** Then nine thirty Central and ten thirty Eastern are one appointment, not two slots an hour apart. We haven't asked to reschedule it.
- 06 **Joel:** Exactly. In ³ _____, Coordinated Universal Time, it is fourteen thirty. Keep the date with each version.
- 07 **Priya:** My ETA currently reads ten fifteen Eastern daylight time on thirteen October. That should be nine fifteen on the receiving clock.
- 08 **Joel:** Yes. Your estimate is ⁴ _____ minutes before the appointment, not forty-five minutes late.
- 09 **Priya:** I'd nearly compared ten fifteen on my screen directly with the unlabelled nine thirty in the note. That would have given the wrong impression.
- 10 **Joel:** The ⁵ _____ is part of the time, not an optional extra. Read both the number and the clock label.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Priya:** Will the gate take me at nine fifteen Central if that estimate holds, or does the appointment only settle the booked time?
- 12 **Joel:** The ⁶ _____ still applies. We don't have a promise of early entry or a parking instruction from this time conversion.
- 13 **Priya:** All right. I won't treat fifteen minutes early as permission to enter or unload. I'll use the actual site directions.
- 14 **Joel:** And keep the ETA provisional. Converting it to another clock doesn't turn the estimate into a guaranteed arrival.
- 15 **Priya:** Could you keep Central as the receiving reference and put Eastern beside it? That would help when the desk calls us back.
- 16 **Joel:** Yes: thirteen October, zero nine thirty CDT, equivalent to ten thirty EDT. I'll retain the same shipment reference, T84.
- 17 **Priya:** Do we use those daylight offsets for every date? I've seen the same place described as Central standard time elsewhere.
- 18 **Joel:** No. Verify the location and date. Standard and daylight labels have different offsets; don't carry today's conversion into a different season without checking.
- 19 **Priya:** My read-back is T84, thirteen October, nine thirty CDT; ten thirty EDT; fourteen thirty UTC. ETA ten fifteen EDT is nine fifteen CDT.
- 20 **Joel:** That's consistent. One appointment, one provisional ETA, the same date, and no automatic early-access permission. Those are the details the next dispatcher needs.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. CDT | 2. 10:30 | 3. UTC | 4. fifteen | 5. time zone | 6. check-in procedure

Put the estimate on the receiving clock

F Say it in a new situation

On 14 October, receiving's appointment is 16:45 EDT (UTC-4). The driver's clock uses CDT (UTC-5), and the ETA is 15:30 CDT that same day. No early-entry agreement is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / 15:45 / fifteen / 20:45

09

Driver: The appointment on my Central daylight clock is ¹ _____ .

Dispatcher: The appointment in UTC is ² _____ .

Driver: My ETA is ³ _____ minutes before the appointment.

Dispatcher: Early entry remains ⁴ _____ .

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 15:45 | 2. 20:45 | 3. fifteen | 4. unconfirmed

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Three clocks in a waiting bill

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Separate actual elapsed time, a contract's chargeable interval, and rounded billing units without rewriting the event record.

Fictional completed stop: gate check-in 07:40, appointment 08:00, release 10:35, same day and zone. This contract starts 120 free minutes at the later of check-in or appointment, then charges \$20 for each started 15-minute block. No other charges apply. Driver Leon and billing coordinator Farah check the calculation; it is not a duty-status or pay determination.

PEOPLE / Leon: Driver | Farah: Billing coordinator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

chargeable interval / dwell time / free time / billing units / release timestamp / check-in timestamp

10

- 01 **Leon:** My stop record runs from seven forty to ten thirty-five. The invoice worksheet only starts at eight. Has someone changed my arrival time?
- 02 **Farah:** No. The ¹ _____ stays seven forty. Eight is the later of your check-in and the booked appointment, which this contract uses.
- 03 **Leon:** So the time physically at the facility is two hours fifty-five, even though the allowance starts twenty minutes after I checked in.
- 04 **Farah:** Yes, the ² _____ is one hundred seventy-five minutes on those endpoints. We keep that actual duration in the record.
- 05 **Leon:** The contract gives one hundred twenty minutes from eight. That takes the no-charge period to ten, rather than nine forty.
- 06 **Farah:** Correct. Here ³ _____ means the contractual period without this detention charge. It does not mean you were off duty or unpaid.
- 07 **Leon:** Release was ten thirty-five, so thirty-five minutes fall after that allowance. Not fifty-five, which I'd get by starting the allowance at arrival.
- 08 **Farah:** That's the ⁴ _____ under these terms. The early twenty minutes remain in the event record but don't move the billing start.
- 09 **Leon:** And the rate says each started fifteen-minute block. Thirty-five minutes uses two full blocks and part of a third.
- 10 **Farah:** So the ⁵ _____ are three blocks. At twenty dollars each, the calculated charge is sixty dollars.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Leon:** Does charging three blocks mean I should change the release to ten forty-five, so the record matches forty-five billed minutes?
- 12 **Farah:** No. Preserve the actual ⁶ _____ of ten thirty-five. Rounding belongs in the calculation, not in a fabricated event time.
- 13 **Leon:** Then the worksheet should show actual dwell one seventy-five, contractual chargeable interval thirty-five, and three billed blocks.
- 14 **Farah:** Yes. Calling all three figures waiting time without labels would make the invoice look inconsistent when each has a different purpose.
- 15 **Leon:** Is the two-hour allowance something I should assume for every customer, or does this contract happen to specify it?
- 16 **Farah:** Use this contract only for this case. Other terms may use another trigger, allowance, rate, or rounding method. Don't present our example as a universal rule.
- 17 **Leon:** And the sixty is the result to submit for billing review, not proof the customer has approved the invoice or that I personally receive sixty?
- 18 **Farah:** Correct. Customer approval and driver compensation are separate matters. This calculation establishes neither, and it doesn't classify your duty status.
- 19 **Leon:** I'll retain seven forty check-in, eight appointment, ten thirty-five release, plus the contract wording supporting the three-block calculation.
- 20 **Farah:** Good. Submit those actual records through the process. Any driving availability still needs its proper assessment; a waiting charge cannot supply extra driving time.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. check-in timestamp | 2. dwell time | 3. free time | 4. chargeable interval | 5. billing units | 6. release timestamp

A later check-in changes the start

F Say it in a new situation

Appointment 13:00, actual check-in 13:10, release 16:01, same zone/day. This fictional contract gives 120 free minutes from the later time, then \$20 per started 15-minute block. No other charges apply.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

51 / four / 13:10 / 80

10

Driver: The contractual allowance begins at ¹ _____.

Coordinator: The chargeable interval is ² _____ minutes.

Driver: That occupies ³ _____ started fifteen-minute blocks.

Coordinator: The calculated charge is \$ ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. 13:10 | 2. 51 | 3. four | 4. 80

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

A car route is not a truck route

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Report a specific vehicle-height conflict and a proposed alternative without treating a routing suggestion as clearance.

Fictional pre-departure call, driver safely parked at the depot: vehicle H7 has verified overall height 4.12 m. A passenger-car route suggests bridge B9, whose posted clearance is 3.90 m. Route C lists a 4.30 m clearance, but other restrictions and current suitability remain unverified. No route is authorized by this exercise.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Driver | Neil: Dispatcher

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

clearance conflict / twenty-two centimeters / vehicle profile / route restrictions / approval status / difference

11

- 01 **Rosa:** I'm checking the route before departure. The car-navigation suggestion uses B9, but H7 is four point one two meters high and the bridge says three point nine zero.
- 02 **Neil:** That is a ¹ _____. The vehicle is taller than the posted opening, not shorter. Don't use that route suggestion as clearance.
- 03 **Rosa:** The difference is point two two meters. I want the note to be specific rather than just say the bridge looks low.
- 04 **Neil:** State ² _____ above the posted clearance. The car route hasn't accounted for the dimensions we're discussing.
- 05 **Rosa:** The saved profile on that screen is a passenger car. The verified four-point-one-two figure is for the actual vehicle H7.
- 06 **Neil:** Then the ³ _____ is wrong for this job. Use the carrier's process for checking vehicle data and an appropriate commercial route.
- 07 **Rosa:** Someone suggested route C. Its listed clearance is four point three zero meters, which is higher than H7 on those figures.
- 08 **Neil:** The arithmetic ⁴ _____ is point one eight meters, eighteen centimeters. That number alone doesn't approve the route.
- 09 **Rosa:** Because we haven't checked other restrictions, the current route information, or whether that figure applies to the exact passage we'd use?
- 10 **Neil:** Correct. Current ⁵ _____ still need review, including the relevant vehicle dimensions and weight restrictions. A higher number is not a complete route assessment.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Rosa:** I'll report B9 as a conflict and C as a proposal for review, not change the dispatch note to C approved.
- 12 **Neil:** Keep its ⁶ _____ explicit. The appropriate route checks and authorization are still required before treating it as the plan.
- 13 **Rosa:** I'm safely parked at the depot for this discussion. We haven't reached the bridge or started trying to find a way through.
- 14 **Neil:** Good. This is pre-departure planning, not a maneuvering instruction. Don't improvise a passage or alter the vehicle to make a number seem workable.
- 15 **Rosa:** Would it help to keep both units in the note: zero point two two meters and twenty-two centimeters, with exceeds rather than spare clearance?
- 16 **Neil:** Yes. Direction matters. Saying twenty-two centimeters without above or below could reverse the meaning and conceal the conflict.
- 17 **Rosa:** And for C, I should call eighteen centimeters the nominal arithmetic difference, not a safety margin we've verified in practice.
- 18 **Neil:** Exactly. Actual safe and lawful suitability needs the proper assessment. A navigation result also never cancels posted restrictions or current advisories.
- 19 **Rosa:** My message is H7, verified height four point one two meters; B9 three point nine zero, a conflict; C four point three zero, other checks unresolved.
- 20 **Neil:** That's the useful read-back. Keep the vehicle identity, units, restriction source, and proposed-route status together. No departure or passage is authorized by this language exercise.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. clearance conflict | 2. twenty-two centimeters | 3. vehicle profile | 4. difference | 5. route restrictions | 6. approval status

State the direction of the difference

F Say it in a new situation

Before departure, a parked driver checks a verified 4.05 m vehicle against a 3.85 m posted clearance. An alternative lists 4.20 m, but other restrictions and current suitability remain unverified. The exercise authorizes no passage.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

20 / unverified / 4.20 / 15

Driver: The vehicle exceeds the first posted clearance by ¹ _____ centimeters.

Dispatcher: The proposed alternative lists ² _____ meters.

Driver: Its nominal difference above the vehicle height is ³ _____ centimeters.

Dispatcher: The alternative route's suitability is still ⁴ _____ .

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 20 | 2. 4.20 | 3. 15 | 4. unverified

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Confirming the delivery destination

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Who is the shipment for?

B. Alder Books in suite 4

The shipment names Alder Books at suite four, not suite six.

2. What is wrong with the route note?

B. The rear annex belongs to suite 6

Hana identifies the rear annex as belonging to a different suite.

3. What remains to be done?

D. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note

The call establishes the conflict but does not itself amend the dispatch record.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which read-back matches the facts?

D. Alder Books, suite 4, staffed front desk.

The read-back preserves the consignee, correct suite, and confirmed receiving point.

2. Which statement wrongly reports completion?

B. Dispatch has already corrected the note.

Dispatch correction is still required and has not occurred in this call.

3. Which question targets the actual ambiguity?

A. Does the rear annex serve suite 4 or suite 6?

The ambiguity concerns which suite uses the named receiving point.

4. What should remain unchanged?

C. The intended consignee, Alder Books

Correcting the receiving-point information does not replace the intended consignee.

01 Conversation answers

Confirming the delivery destination

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. receiving contact. Turn 2. Hana is the contact for Alder Books and can clarify its receiving point, not amend the carrier's route system.

2. rear annex. Turn 4. The rear annex belongs to suite six, not the suite-four consignee named on the shipment.

3. receiving point. Turn 6. The staffed front desk is the specific receiving point for suite four, beyond the building's shared street address.

4. read-back. Turn 8. Repeating the consignee, address, suite, and receiving point lets Hana check the full corrected information.

5. consignee. Turn 10. Alder Books remains the intended receiving party; the entrance correction does not redirect the shipment to another tenant.

6. dispatch. Turn 12. Dispatch is responsible for the carrier's route-note correction; this receiving contact cannot update it through the call.

7. location conflict. Turn 14. The conflict concerns the receiving entrance and suite, not an incorrect street number.

8. adjacent unit. Turn 16. Suite six is a separate neighboring unit, not a second receiving destination for Alder Books.

9. handover. Turn 18. A handover would transfer the goods to the receiving party; none has occurred in this location-clarification call.

10. record amendment. Turn 20. The route record still needs amendment; knowing the corrected information does not make the recorded change complete.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. Birch Print

Driver: "The consignee is Birch Print."

Birch Print remains the named receiving party despite the entrance correction.

2. reception

Receiver: "Suite 2 uses the main reception."

Main reception is the confirmed receiving point for suite two.

3. 3

Driver: "The side-door note belongs to suite 3."

Suite three is the different unit associated with the side door.

4. pending

Receiver: "The record correction is still pending."

Dispatch has not yet amended the conflicting route note.

02 Briefing and language checks

Checking shipment counts

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What does the bill of lading list?

C. Twelve cartons

The document lists twelve cartons as the shipment quantity.

2. What do Priya and Ben physically count?

D. Eleven cartons

Both people agree on eleven present cartons at receiving.

3. What remains unknown?

C. Contents and the location of the twelfth carton

Contents are unchecked, and dispatch has no location for the twelfth carton.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which discrepancy report is accurate?

C. Twelve cartons listed, eleven counted, contents unchecked.

The accurate report preserves both carton figures and the unchecked contents.

2. Which calculation matches the count?

B. One carton below the listed quantity.

Twelve listed minus eleven counted leaves a one-carton difference.

3. Which statement exceeds the evidence?

B. The missing carton is definitely at another depot.

No confirmed location is supplied, so the depot claim is unsupported.

4. What should a follow-up preserve?

D. The quantity basis and unresolved location.

The follow-up must retain carton units and the still-unknown location.

02 Conversation answers

Checking shipment counts

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. listed quantity. Turn 2. Listed quantity is twelve cartons on the document, distinct from the eleven physically counted.

2. short by. Turn 4. Short by introduces the amount below the documented count: one carton rather than eleven.

3. quantity basis. Turn 6. Quantity basis must remain cartons; unchecked contents do not establish how many individual products are missing.

4. contents. Turn 8. Contents means the goods inside the cartons, which neither party has inspected here.

5. unlocated carton. Turn 10. Unlocated carton states the present information limit without declaring a final loss or a known location.

6. discrepancy. Turn 12. Discrepancy is the difference between twelve documented cartons and eleven observed cartons, not a completed delivery count.

7. joint count. Turn 14. Joint count confirms agreement on what is present but does not establish whether the paperwork or movement caused the difference.

8. cause attribution. Turn 16. Cause attribution assigns responsibility or a reason, neither of which follows from this count alone.

9. dispatch follow-up. Turn 18. Dispatch follow-up concerns locating or explaining the unaccounted-for carton, while the existing count stays explicit.

10. physical count. Turn 20. Physical count is the eleven cartons observed, which must remain separate from the document's twelve.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. nine

Driver: "The document lists nine cartons."

Nine is the documented amount against which the actual count is compared.

2. eight

Receiver: "The physical count is eight cartons."

Eight is the number of cartons actually counted at receiving.

3. one

Driver: "The shipment is short by one carton."

Nine listed minus eight counted creates a one-carton difference.

4. unchecked

Receiver: "The contents remain unchecked."

No inspection of the goods inside the cartons has occurred.

03 Briefing and language checks

Updating an arrival estimate

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. When is arrival currently estimated?

B. 11:40

The arrival estimate is eleven forty, separate from the call and update times.

2. How does the estimate compare with the cutoff?

A. Ten minutes after it

Eleven forty is ten minutes later than the eleven-thirty receiving cutoff.

3. What can Mei commit to?

A. An update by 10:40, even if unresolved

Mei can provide a communication update without guaranteeing the receiving decision.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which update is accurate?

A. ETA 11:40; cutoff 11:30; later slot unconfirmed.

The statement retains the estimate, unchanged cutoff, and unconfirmed later arrangement.

2. What does by 10:40 refer to?

B. The deadline for Mei's update

Ten forty is a communication deadline, not a movement or delivery instruction.

3. Which sentence turns a request into a false result?

D. I will ask, so your 11:40 appointment is confirmed.

Asking receiving does not establish that receiving has accepted a later appointment.

4. What should Omar do linguistically?

B. Report the timing conflict without promising to rush.

The useful message states the conflict and avoids unsafe or unsupported timing promises.

03 Conversation answers

Updating an arrival estimate

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. receiving cutoff.** Turn 2. The receiving cutoff is 11:30; an 11:40 estimate is ten minutes after it and does not extend it.
- 2. rescheduling request.** Turn 4. A rescheduling request asks for a changed receiving arrangement; it does not itself confirm a new slot.
- 3. estimated time of arrival.** Turn 6. The estimated time of arrival is the provisional 11:40 expectation, not an accepted appointment.
- 4. by.** Turn 8. By means no later than 10:40 for the communication; it says nothing about delivery completion.
- 5. status update.** Turn 10. A status update conveys the latest position even if receiving has not yet decided on the request.
- 6. time mismatch.** Turn 12. The mismatch is the ten minutes between the 11:30 cutoff and the later 11:40 arrival estimate.
- 7. driver availability.** Turn 14. Driver availability includes lawful and practical limits; a requested appointment cannot override applicable rules or safe operation.
- 8. later slot.** Turn 16. No later receiving slot is confirmed; the dispatcher is only taking the contact action.
- 9. update deadline.** Turn 18. 10:40 is the update deadline, separate from the call at 10:20 and the ETA at 11:40.
- 10. confirmed appointment.** Turn 20. A confirmed appointment requires acceptance of a receiving arrangement; asking for it supplies no such acceptance.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 14:20

Driver: "Estimated arrival is 14:20."

Fourteen twenty is the provisional arrival time, not a confirmed appointment.

2. twenty

Dispatcher: "That is twenty minutes after the cutoff."

Fourteen twenty follows the fourteen-hundred cutoff by twenty minutes.

3. 13:15

Driver: "Your update is due by 13:15."

Thirteen fifteen is the promised communication deadline in the new scenario.

4. unconfirmed

Dispatcher: "A later slot remains unconfirmed."

Receiving has not agreed to an alternative delivery time.

04 Briefing and language checks

Describing a delivery exception

A Briefing checks / page 31

04

1. What is actually visible?

A. A crushed lower corner on one carton

The observed condition concerns one carton corner, not inspected equipment inside.

2. What has not been checked?

A. The contents

The carton remains unopened, so its internal contents have not been inspected.

3. Which result is not established?

D. Internal damage and its cause

Neither the condition of the equipment nor responsibility follows from the observed packaging alone.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which condition note matches the evidence?

C. One carton has a crushed lower corner; contents uninspected.

Only one external corner is observed, while internal condition remains unchecked.

2. Which sentence acknowledges concern without asserting damage?

B. You are concerned that the equipment may be damaged.

The correct wording attributes a possibility while taking the receiver's concern seriously.

3. What does a follow-up referral establish?

D. The issue is being routed for review, not approved as a claim.

Referral starts or continues review without supplying a remedy or acceptance decision.

4. Which distinction separates the observed condition from the still-unchecked condition?

C. Packaging condition versus uninspected contents.

The observed outer condition does not establish what happened inside the carton.

04 Conversation answers

Describing a delivery exception

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. visible condition. Turn 2. Visible condition is the crushed lower corner that can actually be observed, rather than uninspected equipment damage.

2. condition notation. Turn 4. Condition notation preserves the observed packaging issue without turning a concern into a finding about cause or contents.

3. inspection. Turn 6. Inspection has not occurred, so neither damaged nor undamaged contents can be confirmed.

4. attributed statement. Turn 8. Attributed statement identifies the receiver's concern as a concern rather than a verified internal-damage finding.

5. causal claim. Turn 10. Causal claim asserts how the condition arose, which neither the visible corner nor the receiver's suspicion establishes.

6. liability. Turn 12. Liability is responsibility for the event; this factual description neither establishes nor rejects it.

7. crushed corner. Turn 14. Crushed corner describes the lower-corner deformation on one carton, not a whole-shipment or equipment-damage finding.

8. follow-up referral. Turn 16. Follow-up referral routes the reported issue through the actual carrier process without promising a particular outcome.

9. Internal damage. Turn 18. Internal damage concerns the goods inside; their condition remains unknown because the carton has not been inspected.

10. claim approval. Turn 20. Claim approval would require an authorized decision, which this description and referral do not provide.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. tear

Driver: "One carton has a tear in its upper side panel."

Tear is the observed external condition, not a finding about the goods inside.

2. unopened

Receiver: "The contents are still unopened."

The carton has not been opened to examine the internal goods.

3. unverified

Driver: "Internal damage remains unverified."

The concern does not establish damage before an appropriate inspection.

4. established

Receiver: "The cause is not established."

The visible tear does not establish how or by whom it was caused.

05 Briefing and language checks

When the recipient cannot receive

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the situation at 14:10?

B. The receiving office is closed

The driver is outside a closed office, although the listed contact answers the phone.

2. When can Lina return?

B. 15:00, fifty minutes later

Fifteen hundred is fifty minutes after the fourteen-ten call.

3. Which alternative can be reviewed but is not confirmed?

D. Redelivery through dispatch

Dispatch can review redelivery, but no new delivery arrangement has been approved.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which record preserves the facts?

B. Office closed at 14:10; contact answered and can return at 15:00.

The correct record distinguishes an answered call from current receiving availability.

2. Which response correctly addresses waiting?

D. I cannot commit to waiting until 15:00.

The brief states that the driver cannot promise the fifty-minute wait.

3. Which collection statement is accurate?

C. Collection availability has not been confirmed.

Unknown availability supports neither a guaranteed collection nor a universal refusal.

4. What can happen next?

A. Dispatch can review redelivery without promising a slot yet.

Review is the available next step, while the final arrangement remains unconfirmed.

05 Conversation answers

When the recipient cannot receive

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. listed contact. Turn 2. Lina is the named receiving contact and answers remotely, though she is not present to receive the goods.

2. return time. Turn 4. 15:00 is when Lina can return, not a commitment that the driver will wait until then.

3. redelivery. Turn 6. Redelivery is another delivery attempt; its date and time have not been agreed in this case.

4. collection option. Turn 8. A collection option would let Lina pick up the shipment at an appropriate carrier location, but availability is unknown.

5. service availability. Turn 10. Service availability concerns whether collection can actually be offered; preference alone does not confirm it.

6. received status. Turn 12. Received status would claim an actual handover that has not happened; an answered phone call is not receipt of goods.

7. contact outcome. Turn 14. The call was answered and receiving was unavailable in person; those facts must not become a no-response record.

8. release authorization. Turn 16. No permission for unattended release is established; the contact's future return time cannot supply it.

9. dispatch review. Turn 18. Dispatch review is the next assessment, not an already agreed new slot or collection arrangement.

10. unconfirmed alternative. Turn 20. Both redelivery and collection remain possible questions for review, not arrangements Lina can rely on yet.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. forty

Driver: "Your return would be forty minutes from now."

Ten hundred is forty minutes after the nine-twenty call.

2. answered

Contact: "The phone call was answered."

The driver reached the contact, so no-response wording would be inaccurate.

3. confirmed

Driver: "Waiting is not confirmed."

The driver has not agreed to remain until the contact returns.

4. unknown

Contact: "Collection availability is still unknown."

No verified collection option has been supplied in this scenario.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Explaining the booked service boundary

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What service is booked?

D. Curbside delivery

The booking explicitly says curbside and does not include inside service.

2. What does Rafael request?

C. Upstairs placement

Rafael wants the household delivery taken upstairs rather than curbside.

3. What is known about a possible change?

D. Dispatch can review it; availability, price, and timing are unknown

The option is a reviewable request, not an authorized or priced upgrade.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which response explains the boundary accurately?

B. Curbside is booked; upstairs placement needs separate review.

The booking covers curbside service, while the different request remains to be reviewed.

2. Which price statement is supported?

B. No upgrade price has been confirmed.

Neither a quotation nor customer acceptance of a price exists.

3. What does Rafael's review request authorize in the dialogue?

A. Referring the request to dispatch, not performing the upgrade.

The customer asks for an assessment, not an unpriced or unauthorized service change.

4. Which summary keeps all uncertainties?

B. Upgrade availability, price, and timing remain unknown.

No checked proposal exists for availability, price, or timing.

06 Conversation answers

Explaining the booked service boundary

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. booked service.** Turn 2. Booked service is the recorded curbside arrangement, which differs from the requested upstairs placement.
- 2. service amendment.** Turn 4. Service amendment would change the authorized work; the driver cannot approve it in this conversation.
- 3. service scope.** Turn 6. Service scope identifies what this booking includes; it does not establish every possible service the carrier offers.
- 4. quotation.** Turn 8. Quotation would specify a checked price; none exists, and a question does not authorize an unknown charge.
- 5. timing confirmation.** Turn 10. Timing confirmation is absent, so today or any replacement date cannot be promised.
- 6. upgrade request.** Turn 12. Upgrade request names the proposed additional service for review without representing it as approved.
- 7. Assembly.** Turn 14. Assembly means putting parts together and is separate from the placement request Rafael wants reviewed.
- 8. authorization.** Turn 16. Authorization must cover the specific changed service; an informal understanding with the driver is not supplied here.
- 9. change acceptance.** Turn 18. Change acceptance applies to a specific confirmed proposal; none has yet been offered or accepted.
- 10. scope mismatch.** Turn 20. Scope mismatch is the difference between booked curbside delivery and requested upstairs placement, still awaiting review.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. curbside

Driver: "The booked service is curbside delivery."

Curbside is the existing arrangement, not the additional placement requested.

2. room-of-choice

Customer: "I am requesting room-of-choice placement."

Room-of-choice identifies the specific additional service the customer wants reviewed.

3. dispatch

Driver: "The proposed change needs dispatch review."

Dispatch is the team that can assess the requested change here.

4. unknown

Customer: "The price and timing remain unknown."

No checked proposal supplies either cost or a revised schedule.

07 Briefing and language checks

Matching a return to its collection

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does R62 list?

A. Two printer cartons

R62 identifies two printer cartons, not an unrestricted collection of related items.

2. Which item lacks a matching reference?

D. The third carton of cables

The cable carton is additional and has no matching collection reference.

3. What is established by the discussion?

B. The mismatch and a dispatch query, not completed collection

The conversation clarifies identity and follow-up without supplying a collection or credit outcome.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which read-back is accurate?

A. R62 lists two printer cartons; the cable carton is unmatched.

The statement preserves the two matches and isolates the additional cable carton.

2. Which action is available in the conversation?

C. Ask dispatch to query the extra carton.

Dispatch can seek clarification, while adding or collecting the extra carton remains unconfirmed.

3. Which statement goes too far?

D. The unmatched carton is permanently rejected.

Missing information now does not establish a permanent rejection decision.

4. Which status distinction is essential?

C. Reference matched is not the same as collection completed.

Identity verification and actual collection are different stages with different evidence.

07 Conversation answers

Matching a return to its collection

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. cable carton.** Turn 2. The cable carton is the additional third package, not another printer carton under the two-carton booking.
- 2. return reference.** Turn 4. R62 is the return reference for two printer cartons; related accessories are not automatically added to it.
- 3. matching reference.** Turn 6. No matching reference links the cable carton to this pickup; dispatch needs to clarify its arrangement.
- 4. booked quantity.** Turn 8. The booked quantity is two printer cartons even though three cartons have been presented.
- 5. collection booking.** Turn 10. The original booking still identifies two printer cartons; the additional question does not erase those matches.
- 6. unmatched item.** Turn 12. Only the cable carton is unmatched; applying that label to the two identified printers would misstate the check.
- 7. collection amendment.** Turn 14. A collection amendment is an authorized change, not the customer's question or dispatch inquiry by itself.
- 8. collected status.** Turn 16. No pickup has been completed during this reference check, so collected status would be premature.
- 9. credit approval.** Turn 18. A financial credit decision is separate from matching goods to a collection reference or completing a pickup.
- 10. collection scope.** Turn 20. The recorded scope stays at the two printer cartons unless the extra item is properly confirmed and authorized.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. monitor

Driver: "S73 lists three monitor cartons."

Monitor cartons are the goods named in the recorded return scope.

2. keyboard

Customer: "The extra carton contains a keyboard."

The keyboard carton is the additional item lacking a matching reference.

3. unmatched

Driver: "The extra carton remains unmatched."

No record has yet linked the additional carton to the booking.

4. completed

Customer: "The query does not mean collection is completed."

Reference clarification does not establish that any pickup has occurred.

08 Briefing and language checks

Closing a route with a clear handoff

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What happened at stop 7?

C. Mei received the shipment at 16:05, but the receipt upload is missing

The physical receipt occurred, while its electronic document upload remains unfinished.

2. What is the known reason given at stop 8?

C. The customer reported a duplicate order

Duplicate order is the customer's stated reason for refusal, not an independently verified finding.

3. What does Jo accept?

B. Both unfinished follow-ups

Jo takes ownership of the receipt check and customer-service contact without completing them.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which stop-7 statement is accurate?

A. Received by Mei at 16:05; receipt upload pending.

The statement preserves the receiver, timestamp, and separate unfinished electronic record.

2. Which stop-8 wording preserves attribution?

C. The customer reported a duplicate order and refused the delivery.

The customer's explanation must remain attributed rather than promoted to a verified cause.

3. Which handoff wrongly claims completion?

C. Jo accepted the tasks, so both issues are resolved.

Ownership acceptance assigns future work but does not supply its completed outcome.

4. Which action pair belongs to Jo?

B. Check stop-7 receipt upload and contact customer service about stop 8.

The two assigned tasks match the distinct unfinished items in the briefing.

08 Conversation answers

Closing a route with a clear handoff

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. stop outcome.** Turn 2. Stop outcome describes what actually happened at each location, before discussing unfinished records or follow-up.
- 2. receipt upload.** Turn 4. Receipt upload is the unfinished electronic transfer, not an uncompleted physical delivery at stop seven.
- 3. Record completeness.** Turn 6. Record completeness concerns the missing receipt in the system and must not erase the actual receiving event.
- 4. refusal reason.** Turn 8. Refusal reason is the customer's reported duplicate order, not an independently established ordering error.
- 5. customer service.** Turn 10. Customer service is the team Jo will approach about stop eight; that contact has not yet resolved the issue.
- 6. action owner.** Turn 12. Action owner names Jo as responsible for both next steps without implying either step is already complete.
- 7. receipt timestamp.** Turn 14. Receipt timestamp belongs to Mei's receiving event at stop seven and must not be reassigned to the refusal.
- 8. read-back confirmation.** Turn 16. Read-back confirmation checks the two outcomes, pending tasks, and ownership before the driver leaves.
- 9. Independent verification.** Turn 18. Independent verification of the alleged duplicate has not occurred, so the customer's reason remains an attributed report.
- 10. Route closure.** Turn 20. Route closure requires the relevant process to be completed; this handoff only transfers the two unfinished actions.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. Noor

Driver: "Stop 3 was received by Noor at 12:25."

Noor is the named receiver for the physically completed receiving event.

2. pending

Dispatcher: "The receipt upload remains pending."

The physical delivery does not establish completion of the electronic upload.

3. reported

Driver: "The unwanted-order reason was reported by the customer."

Reported preserves attribution without claiming independent verification of the customer's explanation.

4. Ana

Dispatcher: "The next action owner is Ana."

Ana accepts both unfinished follow-ups without claiming they are already completed.

08

09 Conversation answers

Whose nine thirty?

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. CDT. Turn 2. The appointment is 09:30 Central Daylight Time, not 09:30 on the dispatcher's Eastern clock.

2. 10:30. Turn 4. 09:30 at UTC-5 is the same instant as 10:30 at UTC-4, on the same date.

3. UTC. Turn 6. Coordinated Universal Time gives a common reference: both local appointment times convert to 14:30 UTC.

4. fifteen. Turn 8. 09:15 CDT is fifteen minutes before the 09:30 CDT appointment, after both times are put on the same clock.

5. time zone. Turn 10. The time-zone label identifies which local clock a number belongs to; omitting it creates an invalid comparison.

6. check-in procedure. Turn 12. A confirmed appointment does not grant early gate entry; the actual check-in procedure remains applicable.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 15:45

Driver: The appointment on my Central daylight clock is 15:45 .

Eastern daylight time is one hour ahead of Central daylight time, so 16:45 EDT equals 15:45 CDT.

2. 20:45

Dispatcher: The appointment in UTC is 20:45 .

Adding four hours to 16:45 EDT gives 20:45 UTC on the same date.

3. fifteen

Driver: My ETA is fifteen minutes before the appointment.

15:30 CDT is fifteen minutes earlier than the equivalent appointment at 15:45 CDT.

4. unconfirmed

Dispatcher: Early entry remains unconfirmed .

A clock conversion and early ETA do not establish permission to enter the receiving site.

Background reading: [NIST: local time, standard/daylight labels, and UTC offsets](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Three clocks in a waiting bill

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

- 1. check-in timestamp.** Turn 2. The actual check-in remains 07:40; choosing a contractual billing start does not change when the driver arrived.
- 2. dwell time.** Turn 4. From 07:40 to 10:35 is 175 elapsed minutes at the facility; that is distinct from the contractual chargeable interval.
- 3. free time.** Turn 6. The contract's 120 free minutes run from 08:00 to 10:00; free describes billing, not off-duty time or wages.
- 4. chargeable interval.** Turn 8. The period after the 10:00 end of free time and before 10:35 release is 35 minutes under these fictional terms.
- 5. billing units.** Turn 10. Thirty-five minutes occupies three started fifteen-minute blocks; the third partial block is charged under the stated contract.
- 6. release timestamp.** Turn 12. The release remains 10:35; rounding the charge into three blocks does not change the actual event to 10:45.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

- 1. 13:10**
Driver: The contractual allowance begins at 13:10 .
The later of the 13:00 appointment and 13:10 check-in is 13:10.
- 2. 51**
Coordinator: The chargeable interval is 51 minutes.
The allowance ends at 15:10; release at 16:01 is fifty-one minutes later.
- 3. four**
Driver: That occupies four started fifteen-minute blocks.
Three blocks cover only forty-five minutes; fifty-one minutes starts a fourth.
- 4. 80**
Coordinator: The calculated charge is \$80 .
Four blocks multiplied by twenty dollars gives eighty, without changing the actual release time.

10

Background reading: **FMCSA: distinguishing facility dwell and detention.** The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

A car route is not a truck route

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. clearance conflict. Turn 2. The vehicle height of 4.12 m exceeds the posted 3.90 m clearance, so the suggested route has a direct height conflict.

2. twenty-two centimeters. Turn 4. 4.12 m minus 3.90 m equals 0.22 m, or 22 cm, by which the vehicle exceeds the posted clearance.

3. vehicle profile. Turn 6. The vehicle profile must reflect the actual truck; a passenger-car profile does not establish a suitable route for H7.

4. difference. Turn 8. 4.30 m minus 4.12 m gives a nominal 0.18 m difference, not an authorization or guarantee of safe passage.

5. route restrictions. Turn 10. Route restrictions include more than a single height figure; route C's complete suitability remains unverified.

6. approval status. Turn 12. Route C is proposed and unverified, not approved merely because its listed clearance exceeds the recorded vehicle height.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 20

Driver: The vehicle exceeds the first posted clearance by 20 centimeters.

4.05 minus 3.85 equals 0.20 m, or twenty centimeters above the posted clearance.

2. 4.20

Dispatcher: The proposed alternative lists 4.20 meters.

4.20 m is the alternative's listed clearance, not the vehicle's height or the first restriction.

3. 15

Driver: Its nominal difference above the vehicle height is 15 centimeters.

4.20 minus 4.05 is 0.15 m, or fifteen centimeters, without establishing safe suitability.

4. unverified

Dispatcher: The alternative route's suitability is still unverified .

Other restrictions and current suitability have not been checked, so the arithmetic alone cannot approve the route.

11

Background reading: [FMCSA: commercial-vehicle navigation and posted restrictions](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Confirming the delivery destination

Identify the shipment: I am calling about shipment 418 for Alder Books.

Name the conflict: My route note says rear annex.

Read back the full detail: Alder Books, suite 4, staffed front desk; correct?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Checking shipment counts

Name the document: The bill of lading lists twelve cartons.

Keep units explicit: I mean cartons, not individual products.

Avoid blame: We do not yet know the cause of the difference.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Updating an arrival estimate

State the call time: It is 10:20, and I am parked for this call.

Quantify the mismatch: That puts the estimate ten minutes after the cutoff.

State the open status: No later slot is confirmed yet.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Describing a delivery exception

Acknowledge the concern: I can see why that corner concerns you.

State the inspection status: The contents have not been inspected.

Attribute the concern: You are concerned that the equipment may be damaged.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 When the recipient cannot receive

State the present position: I am outside the closed receiving office at 14:10.

Repeat the return time: You can return at 15:00; is that correct?

Offer a review: Dispatch can review a redelivery arrangement.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Explaining the booked service boundary

Acknowledge the expectation: I understand you expected the item upstairs.

State your authority: I cannot add upstairs placement myself.

Keep price open: No upgrade price has been confirmed.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Matching a return to its collection

Identify the booking: I am here for return collection R62.

Name the additional item: The third carton contains cables according to your description.

Avoid silent expansion: I cannot treat R62 as a three-carton booking without confirmation.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Closing a route with a clear handoff

Name the route: I am handing over the open items from route 12.

State the missing record: The receipt has not uploaded.

Preserve uncertainty: That reason has not been independently verified.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

abrasion describe an abrasion	33
acceptance decision clarify the acceptance decision	33
access requirement confirm access requirements	51
accessorial charge clarify an accessorial charge	50
action owner name the action owner	69
additional carton query the additional carton	59
address line preserve the address line	5
after arrive after the cutoff	23
answered call distinguish an answered call	41
appointment slot request an appointment slot	23
assembly distinguish assembly from delivery	51
at call at 10:20	23
attributed statement preserve an attributed statement	32
authorization obtain authorization	51
availability check request an availability check	50
before contact receiving before arrival	23
bill of lading compare the bill of lading	14
booked quantity preserve the booked quantity	59
booked service verify the booked service	50
by update by 10:40	23
cable carton distinguish the cable carton	59
carrier contact the carrier	5
carrier location verify the carrier location	41
carton count the cartons	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

causal claim qualify a causal claim	32
cause attribution avoid unsupported cause attribution	15
change acceptance obtain change acceptance	51
claim refer a claim	33
claim approval avoid promising claim approval	33
clearance verify overhead clearance	6
closed premises report closed premises	41
collected status verify collected status	60
collection amendment request a collection amendment	60
collection booking check the collection booking	59
collection option check the collection option	41
collection scope clarify the collection scope	59
completion status preserve completion status	69
concealed damage report suspected concealed damage	33
condition notation make a condition notation	32
confirmed appointment distinguish a confirmed appointment	24
consignee confirm the consignee	5
contact attempt record a contact attempt	41
contact outcome document the contact outcome	42
contents distinguish cartons from contents	15
credit approval distinguish credit approval	60
crushed corner record the crushed corner	32
curbside delivery confirm curbside delivery	50
customer expectation clarify the customer expectation	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

customer service	contact customer service	69
damage allegation	attribute a damage allegation	32
delay notification	send a delay notification	24
delivery address	verify the delivery address	5
delivery attempt	record the delivery attempt	42
delivery exception	report a delivery exception	32
delivery receipt	review the delivery receipt	32
delivery receipt	locate the delivery receipt	68
delivery record	update the delivery record	6
delivery window	clarify the delivery window	23
destination correction	request a destination correction	6
detention charge	explain the detention charge	42
discrepancy	document a discrepancy	14
dispatch	notify dispatch	6
dispatch follow-up	request dispatch follow-up	15
dispatch review	request dispatch review	42
driver availability	verify driver availability	24
dwel time	record the dwel time	41
entrance	clarify the entrance	5
estimated time of arrival	update the estimated time of arrival	23
external packaging	describe external packaging	32
fault	avoid assigning fault	33
follow-up owner	identify the follow-up owner	42
follow-up referral	make a follow-up referral	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

handover confirm the handover	6
hours of service follow hours-of-service requirements	24
independent verification request independent verification	69
inside delivery distinguish inside delivery	50
inspection request an inspection	32
installation distinguish installation from placement	51
internal damage distinguish internal damage	32
item description compare the item description	60
item quantity check the item quantity	15
item separation maintain item separation	60
joint count confirm the joint count	15
later slot ask about a later slot	23
liability distinguish liability from observation	33
line item compare the line item	14
listed contact call the listed contact	41
listed quantity state the listed quantity	14
loaded status distinguish loaded status	60
location conflict report a location conflict	6
matching reference locate a matching reference	59
missing document follow up a missing document	68
new slot confirm a new slot	42
no response avoid an inaccurate no-response note	42
observation separate observation from inference	33
on duty clarify on-duty status	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

open item list the open items	69
overage report an overage	15
ownership acceptance confirm ownership acceptance	69
packing description confirm the packing description	60
packing list consult the packing list	14
pallet distinguish pallets from cartons	14
pending response record a pending response	24
physical count perform a physical count	14
piece count verify the piece count	14
presented quantity compare the presented quantity	59
price confirmation await price confirmation	51
printer carton identify the printer carton	59
proof of delivery check proof of delivery	68
provisional give a provisional estimate	24
puncture identify a puncture	33
quantity basis state the quantity basis	15
query raise a query	60
quotation obtain a quotation	50
read-back request a complete read-back	6
read-back confirmation request read-back confirmation	69
rear annex distinguish the rear annex	5
rearrangement discuss a rearrangement	50
receipt timestamp preserve the receipt timestamp	68
receipt upload verify the receipt upload	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

received by record received by Mei	68
received status distinguish received status	42
receiving confirmation obtain receiving confirmation	24
receiving contact call the receiving contact	6
receiving cutoff confirm the receiving cutoff	23
receiving office check the receiving office	41
receiving point confirm the receiving point	5
receiving tally compare the receiving tally	15
recipient unavailable report recipient unavailable	41
record amendment confirm the record amendment	6
record completeness verify record completeness	68
recount request a recount	14
redelivery request redelivery review	41
reference match establish a reference match	60
refusal reason attribute the refusal reason	69
refused delivery record a refused delivery	69
release authorization verify release authorization	42
reported duplicate record the reported duplicate	69
rescheduling request submit a rescheduling request	24
resolution distinguish referral from resolution	69
return authorization verify return authorization	59
return disposition await return disposition	60
return label check the return label	60
return merchandise authorization quote the return merchandise authorization	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

return reference confirm the return reference	59
return time confirm the return time	41
revised estimate issue a revised estimate	24
room-of-choice service check room-of-choice service	50
route closure verify route closure	68
route handoff give a route handoff	68
route note check the route note	5
route summary provide a route summary	69
schedule constraint explain a schedule constraint	24
scope mismatch explain the scope mismatch	51
serial number verify the serial number	60
service amendment confirm a service amendment	51
service availability confirm service availability	42
service boundary state the service boundary	50
service scope explain the service scope	50
shipment reference quote the shipment reference	5
shipper identify the shipper	5
shipping unit identify the shipping unit	14
short by report short by one carton	15
shortage report a carton shortage	14
site instruction verify the site instruction	6
staffed front desk identify the staffed front desk	5
stair carry ask about stair-carry service	51
status update provide a status update	23

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stop number state the stop number	6
stop outcome state the stop outcome	68
suite number read back the suite number	5
synchronization check synchronization status	68
tear describe a tear	33
time mismatch report a time mismatch	23
timing confirmation await timing confirmation	51
trace request raise a trace request	15
unattended delivery clarify unattended-delivery authorization	42
unchecked mark contents as unchecked	15
unconfirmed alternative explain an unconfirmed alternative	42
unloading status clarify the unloading status	51
unlocated carton report the unlocated carton	15
unmatched item isolate the unmatched item	59
unopened carton identify the unopened carton	32
update deadline state the update deadline	23
upgrade request submit an upgrade request	50
upload pending report upload pending	68
upstairs placement request upstairs placement	50
UTC offset state the UTC offset	24
vehicle profile verify the vehicle profile	6
visible condition report the visible condition	32
waiting commitment avoid an unconfirmed waiting commitment	41
wet patch note a wet patch	33

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Heavy and Tractor-trailer Truck Drivers.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for driver-dispatch communication, delivery records, and reported problems. These original conversations do not provide vehicle-operation instructions. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] FedEx. Shipping Terms and Definitions.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology reference for shipment parties, transport documents, tracking, and additional services. Fictional service arrangements are not FedEx terms or quotations. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration. Hours of Service.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for distinguishing a customer request from the rules and constraints governing actual driver availability. No numerical driving-time rule is taught in this book. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Trucking Industry: Loading and Unloading.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for keeping language practice separate from site-specific loading and unloading training. The book does not authorize handling equipment or entering loading areas. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

All shipments, people, businesses, times, references, and service arrangements are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not driving, loading, vehicle operation, cargo securement, legal liability, or regulatory compliance. Calls occur while the driver is safely parked or away from driving duties. Follow applicable road and working-time rules, carrier procedures, site safety requirements, and emergency arrangements. Do not use these dialogues as authorization to move, unload, leave, sign for, or alter the service for a real shipment.

English Ladder | English for Work | 2026 edition. The B2-C1 range is an editorial study recommendation, not a proficiency certification.

[Open the matching English Ladder course](#)